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bl portfolio



Technical analysis.
What you need
to know about
the spike in US
Treasury yields
BIG STORY P2



IPO watch.
**Our take on
LEAP, DTL,
Molbio, Milky Mist
public offerings**
TAKING STOCK P4 & 5

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Retail participation in IPOs turns lacklustre as investors eye quality over listing gains

MODERATE DEMAND. Only five of 12 issues in July saw double-digit retail oversubscription; six recorded single-digit demand

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Notwithstanding the early signs of a revival in the primary market, retail participation in initial public offerings (IPOs) has remained lacklustre as investors have focussed on the quality of issuances over the lure of listing day gains.

Of the 12 issues that hit the market in July, the retail portion of only five was subscribed in double digits, while six companies registered single-digit subscription.

Retail participation in an IPO refers to individual investors applying for shares of up to ₹2 lakh in mainboard issues. Mainboard IPOs typically reserve at least 35 per cent of the net offer for retail individual investors.

The retail portion of the ₹9,275-crore Manipal Health Enterprises — the second biggest issue this year, after SBI Funds Man-



agement — was undersubscribed as it received bids for only 93 per cent of the shares on offer.

The company recorded a listing day gain of 11 per cent.

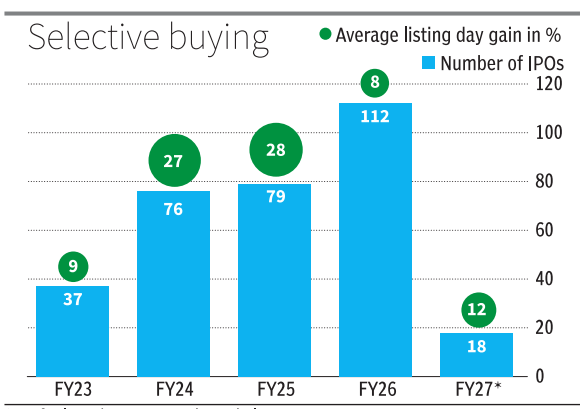
The retail portion of the SBI Funds Management IPO of ₹9,812 crore was subscribed four times. It registered a listing day gain of 7 per cent.

The funds raised and the number of IPOs in July have been the highest so far in 2026 as sentiment in the

secondary markets has bounced back. In all, 12 companies raised ₹28,646 crore last month, against seven companies mopping up ₹2,718 crore in June, according to data sourced from PRIME Database.

LISTING GAINS DIP Pranav Haldea, Managing Director, PRIME Database Group, said retail investors primarily come in for listing gains, as corroborated by a SEBI study.

With the average listing



gain falling from 30 per cent in 2024 to just 6 per cent in 2026, retail participation has dipped, as is also shown by the average number of IPO applications, which have declined from 18.86 lakh in 2024 to just 9.85 lakh in 2026.

“Investing for listing gains is a completely acceptable strategy. My only advice to retail investors, though, would be to exit even if the IPO lists at a discount, as they have not done any analysis on the long-term pro-

spects of the company,” he said.

INVESTMENT AVENUES Uday Patil, Executive Director, PL Capital, said the lacklustre retail participation in IPOs can be attributed to weak post listing performance, higher valuations, availability of alternative investment opportunities, and macro-economic uncertainties.

“Valuation continues to be one of the primary concerns from the retail in-

vestors’ perspective. Gone are the days when most IPOs were heavily oversubscribed only to benefit from listing gains,” he said.

Gaurav Bhandari, CEO, Monarch Network Capital, said the average listing gains have collapsed to 8 per cent last fiscal from 30 per cent in FY25, with median gains at just 3 per cent. Retail participation in India has always been a listing-gain game, not an equity-ownership decision. Moreover, issuers and bankers price in the entire next three years of earnings, leaving no margin for the buyer, he said.

Krishna Patwari, Founder and Managing Director of Wealth Wisdom India, said the SEBI data for June suggests that retail investors are becoming more selective and do not want to fund promoters’ exit.

Mainboard IPOs raised ₹1,652 crore across just three issues, with about 60 per cent of the issues comprising Offers-for-Sale, he said.

INVESTMENT FOCUS.

Technical Call: EID Parry India — Buy

Gurumurthy K
bl, research bureau

The long-term outlook is bullish for EID Parry India (₹805).

The stock has been in a strong downtrend since August 2025. But this downtrend seems to have come to an end. The recent bounce from the low of ₹698 made in June is giving an early sign of a bullish trend reversal.

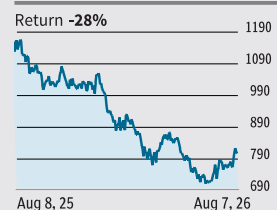
This rise is happening from a strong long-term trend line as well as the 55-Month Moving Average (currently at ₹709). This gives an early sign of a bottom formation.

Strong support is in the ₹730-700 region. A fall below ₹700 is less likely.

Fresh buyers are likely to come in around this support zone and limit the downside. Immediate resistance is at ₹830.

Moving average cross overs on the daily chart also strengthens the bullish case.

Above that, ₹900-920 is the next key resistance



EID Parry India share price can rally to ₹1,400 in the long term

zone. A break above the resistance zone will confirm the trend reversal.

TRADING STRATEGY

That will strengthen the bullish case to see a rally to ₹1,400 over the next couple of years.

Long-term investors can buy EID Parry India shares now at ₹805.

Accumulate on dips at ₹760. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹880 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹990. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,020 and ₹1,130 when the price touches ₹1,110 and ₹1,270, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,360.

I-DAY PREPARATIONS



STAGE SET. Preparations in full swing at the Red Fort for the Independence Day celebrations. The Archaeological Survey of India ordered the closure of Red Fort to prepare the historic site for the Prime Minister’s address to the nation and the flag-hoisting ceremony on the occasion of the 80th Independence Day. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Share of insured deposits slips below 40% in FY26

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

Following the crisis in several co-operative banks in recent times, concerns are rising that the money investors park in banks is not adequately insured.

A *businessline* analysis of Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC) data revealed that in FY26, the value of insured deposits as a share of total assessable deposits slipped below 40 per cent for the first time since the deposit limit for insurance cover was increased to ₹5 lakh in February 2020.

The proportion of bank accounts that remained fully protected, however, stayed above 97 per cent.

DEPOSIT COVER FALLS DICGC has been operating the deposit insurance scheme

since 1962. If a covered bank fails, DICGC protects up to ₹5 lakh per depositor per bank, including interest. This limit applies to all of ones savings, current, fixed and recurring deposits in that one bank, taken together.

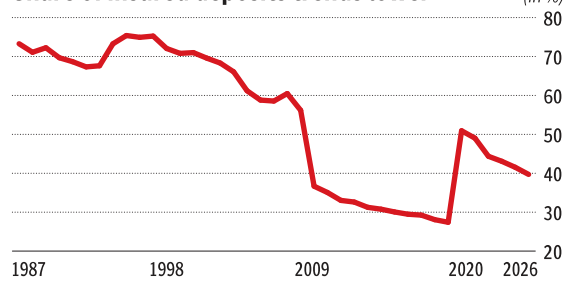
The value of insured deposits accounted for 39.7 per cent of assessable deposits in FY26, down from 41.5 per cent in FY25. The decline extends a longer-term trend since the high of 50.9 per cent recorded in 2020, following the enhancement of the deposit insurance limit to ₹5 lakh from ₹1 lakh.

Since then, rapid growth in deposit balances, in a limited number of accounts, appears to have outpaced the insured portion of deposits, pulling the ratio lower each year.

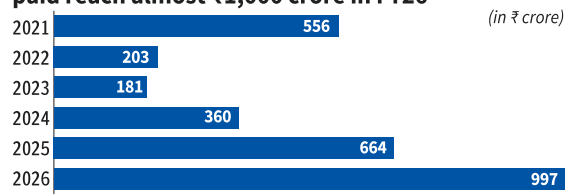
According to Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at Bank of Baroda, “the higher denominator is due to bulk deposits which are large and

Lower cover

Share of insured deposits trends lower



Deposit insurance claims admitted but not paid reach almost ₹1,000 crore in FY26



Source: RBI

hence the ratio is low. If there were more retail deposits, it would be higher.”

Another banking expert

said the average deposit size for the retail customer is ₹1.43 lakh. Therefore, it could be at least five years before the RBI

considers increasing the insured deposit limit. The share of fully protected accounts remained overwhelmingly high at 97.38 per cent in FY26, only marginally lower than 97.56 per cent in FY25 and 97.78 per cent in FY24.

PENDING CLAIMS RISE

Deposit insurance claims admitted but not paid rose to ₹997 crore in FY26, the highest level ever. This marks a sharp turnaround from the post-Covid low of ₹181 crore in FY23, suggesting that admitted claims are accumulating faster than they are being settled.

According to Vivek Iyer, Partner at Grant Thornton Bharat, “the rise in admitted but unpaid deposit insurance claims are primarily driven by administrative delays in distressed cooperative banks, scheduled commercial banks and incomplete depositor data.”

FPIs pumped in ₹12,290 cr in Aug first week

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) turned decisive net buyers in Indian markets in the first week of August, investing a net ₹12,290.68 crore across equity, debt, hybrid and mutual fund segments between August 3 and 7, according to National Securities Depository Ltd (NSDL) data.

The equity segment accounted for the bulk of the inflows, attracting ₹12,921.14 crore during the five-session week, indicating that the buying momentum seen in July has carried into August.

August 5 was the strongest session, with equities drawing ₹9,323.38 crore.

Inflows were ₹1,351.02 crore on August 3 and ₹1,431.45 crore on August 4, before moderating to ₹349 crore on August 6 and

₹466.29 crore on August 7.

MIXED IN DEBT

The debt segment was mixed. FPIs invested ₹621.69 crore through the Debt-General Limit route, but this was more than offset by outflows from the Debt-Voluntary Retention Route (₹354.20 crore) and Debt-Fully Accessible Route (₹377 crore).

Hybrid instruments saw net outflows of ₹570.74 crore, while mutual fund routes recorded marginal inflows of ₹49.79 crore. There was no activity through Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs).

Overall, FPI flows stood at a net ₹2,245.57 crore on August 3 and ₹814.09 crore on August 4, before surging to ₹9,953.64 crore on August 5.

Flows turned negative on August 6 and 7, with net outflows of ₹446.41 crore and ₹276.21 crore, respectively.

Market experts attributed the buying to improving investor sentiment and stronger corporate earnings.

STRONGER EARNINGS

VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments Ltd, said the trend of FPIs turning buyers, which was pronounced in July, has continued into August.

He said FPIs continued to invest in the debt market through the debt-general limit and showed a preference for automobiles, consumer durables and healthcare, where Q1FY27 earnings indicated healthy growth.

Vijayakumar also noted continued FPI investment in mid- and small-cap growth stocks, but cautioned that elevated US bond yields could attract funds to safer US bond markets and limit the durability of the buying trend.

Pabitro Mukherjee, Deputy Vice-President-Research at Bajaj Broking, said sustained buying by foreign and domestic institutional investors was largely driven by the de-escalation of geopolitical tensions, which boosted investor confidence and market sentiment.

Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer at Master Capital Services Ltd, attributed the positive mood to easing US-Iran tensions, better-than-expected Q1 earnings, robust auto sales and a balanced RBI monetary policy stance.

N ArunaGiri, Founder and CEO of Trustline Holdings, said India could benefit from a broader global capital rotation, with investors potentially shifting from crowded AI trades to relatively under-owned markets such as India.

He said the geopolitical situation in West Asia remains the key variable to watch.

Sprint 2.0 to transform retail, industrial businesses, brand image: IOC Chairman

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

State-run Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) will leverage Project Sprint 2.0 to transform its retail business, focusing not only on strengthening and expanding its retail outlets, but also on enhancing brand visibility and building a more customer-centric image.

The country’s largest fuel retailer, which operates more than 40 per cent of India’s 1.07 lakh-odd petrol pumps, aims to strengthen its presence in high fuel- and product-consuming markets while sharpening its consumer focus across retail, commercial and industrial segments.

“Sprint is not only about costs. It is also about expanding market share, enhancing operational efficiency and optimising operations,” IOC



AS Sahney, Chairman, IOC

Chairman AS Sahney told *businessline*. Project Sprint helped the company save around ₹2,200 crore last year. Its Fuel & Loss stood at 8 per cent in Q1FY27, down from 8.5 per cent in Q1FY26, providing further scope for savings, he said.

“Q1FY27 was the most difficult quarter that any oil and gas company has faced. What worked for IOC during the West Asia conflict was our optimisation measures and op-

erational efficiency initiatives. We started these initiatives a year ago under Project Sprint,” Sahney said.

Launched on April 1, 2025, Sprint was Sahney’s first major strategic initiative as chairman. It focuses on strengthening core capabilities and improving operational efficiency, technology adoption, customer-centricity, sustainable growth and talent development.

PROJECT SPRINT 2.0

Sprint is a three-year initiative, Sahney said, adding that the first phase provided key learnings. Sprint 2.0, launched on April 1, 2026, has more ambitious yet practical targets.

“We have become very serious about customer focus and brand image, including retail outlets and the industrial business group. We are trying to take all of them to-

gether. Retail sales are now a separate business unit, which will provide greater focus to our product sales efforts through retail outlets,” he said.

A key driver of Sprint 2.0 is IOC’s expanding refining capacity. The company is expected to have 27 million tonnes per annum (mtpa) of cumulative capacity by the end of FY27, with 9 mtpa already added and another 17.3 mtpa likely to come online by December 2026.

IOC expects refinery throughput to rise from 77 mtpa in FY27 to 85 mtpa in FY28 and 90 mtpa in FY29. It has also created a Profitability Improvement Group in its refinery division under Sprint.

IOC Director (Finance) Anuj Jain said during the company’s Q1FY27 analyst call that Sprint 2.0 is expected to generate savings of ₹2,000-2,500 crore in FY27.

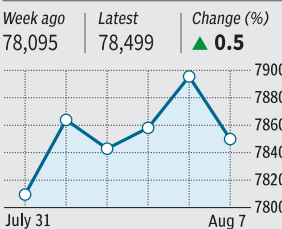
WISE WORDS.

“ I used to think that if there was reincarnation, I wanted to come back as the president or the pope or as a .400 baseball hitter. But now I would like to come back as the bond market. You can intimidate everybody

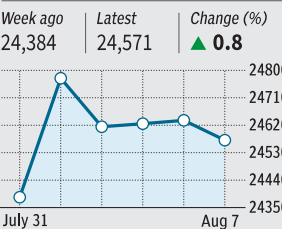
JAMES CARVILLE
Political advisor to Bill Clinton

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



No signs of yielding

TREASURY CHECK. The US Treasury Yields have been on the rise ever since the US-Iran war started. Where are the yields headed from here? How would other assets be impacted? Here’s our technical analysis

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The US Treasury Yield (far end, the 30Yr) touched its highest level since 2007 last month. The 30Yr Treasury yield reached a high of 5.28 per cent on July 31, 2026, the highest level seen since July 2007. The 20Yr Yield rose to a high of 5.3 per cent in July, its highest since 2023. Yields across other tenors (2Yr, 5Yr and 10Yr) also breached their respective highs made in 2025.

Indeed, the Treasury Yields have been on the rise ever since the US-Iran war started. Prior to this rise, yields had come down at the beginning of this year. Here we look at why the yields were falling at the beginning of the year and what are the factors that triggered a reversal and took it higher to the current levels. In the second part, we analyse where the yields are headed from here using technical analysis and what it would mean for other assets. For reference, we consider the 10Yr Treasury yield all through this article.

RATE-CUT PROSPECTS

The US 10Yr Yield, which had closed at around 4.16 per cent in December 2025, rose to a high of 4.3 per cent in early February. From there, it fell sharply to a make a low of 3.93 per cent on March 2, 2026.

The US Federal Reserve had projected for a 50 basis points (bps) interest rate cut in 2026. The Fed in December 2025 reduced the interest rate by 25 bps to 3.5-3.75 per cent. In its economic projections released at that time, the central bank had kept the doors open for another 50-bps cut in 2026. This was a major factor that was weighing on the US Yields at the beginning of this year.

SUDDEN REVERSAL

The yields started moving higher after the US-Iran conflict. Oil prices surged as the war started. The fear of supply disruption on the back of the closure of the Strait of Hormuz triggered this price rise in oil.

The West Texas Intermediate (WTI) Crude Oil Futures traded on the New York Mercantile Exchange (NYMEX) spiked from around \$67 per barrel to a high of about \$115 per barrel in just one week after the war started. It then stayed in a wide range of about \$85-107 until mid-May. After falling to a low of about \$67 again in early July, the WTI Crude Oil price is currently trading around \$76 per barrel.

Concerns over an elevated inflation started emanating as the oil price spiked after the war began. This aided the yields move higher from their lows along with the oil price.

Indeed, high oil prices took the US Headline Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation from 2.4 per cent (year-on-year) in February to 4.2 per cent in May.

Now, what is next for the yields? Will they continue to go up? What are the factors that can push the yields higher from here? Here is our take.

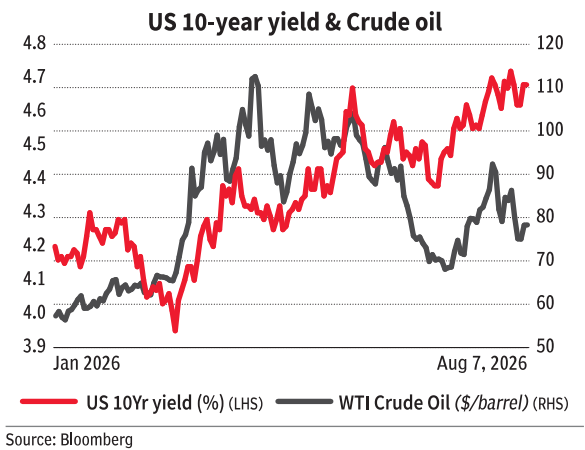
WAR AND OIL

There has been a heightened volatility ever since the US-Iran war started. As long as the war is in place, oil prices will continue to be the major driver of the US Yields as temporary ceasefires are not withstanding.

The WTI Crude Oil (\$76) has a cluster of supports in the \$65-60 region. Unless the war ends, the chances of the WTI Crude Oil price going below \$60 are unlikely. So, as long as the war is in progress, the WTI Crude Oil can sustain above \$60 and go back up to \$100 and \$110 again.

If the situation escalates, there is a potential to see even \$130 on the upside. For now, we expect a wide range of \$60-120 for the WTI Crude Oil.

So, high oil prices can keep the US Yields higher. Oil prices

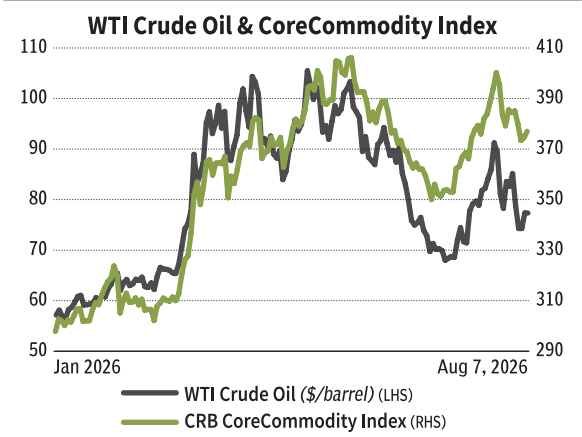


Source: Bloomberg

must decline below \$60 for the US Yields to go down.

CORECOMMODITY CRB INDEX

The FTSE CoreCommodity CRB Index is a benchmark that constitutes a basket of 19 physical commodities. The index is currently at 372. WTI Crude Oil has the highest weightage (23 per cent) in this index. The chart below clearly shows



Source: Tradingview

that the recent movement in the index is in tandem with WTI Crude Oil.

The CoreCommodity CRB Index has a very good support around 335. Though an intermediate fall to test this support is possible, a break below 335 is less likely. Broadly, we expect the index to remain in the range of 335-400.

This supports our view of the downside being limited to \$60 in the WTI Crude Oil mentioned earlier.

FED OUTLOOK SHIFT

High inflation has now changed the narrative of the US Fed recently. Indeed, the sentiment in the market also started tilting towards more hawkish stance ever since Kevin Warsh was announced as the new Chairman of the US Federal Reserve.

The Fed has kept the interest rates unchanged at 3.5-3.75 per cent since the beginning of this year. However, in its economic projections released in June, the central bank opened the doors for one rate hike this year. This is a major shift from its earlier forecast to cut the interest rates by 50 bps. The possibility of one more rate hike has also helped the US Yields to sustain higher over the last couple of months.

YIELDS: TECHNICAL OUTLOOK

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.65 per cent) has a very strong support around 4.5-4.45 per cent. It can rise to 4.8 per cent in the short term. Thereafter, a corrective fall to 4.7-4.65 per cent can be seen. Indeed, we cannot rule out the possibility



Source: Bloomberg

of 4.5-4.8 per cent for some time.

But eventually, we expect the US 10Yr Treasury Yield to breach 4.8 per cent and rise to 5 per cent in the first half of next year.

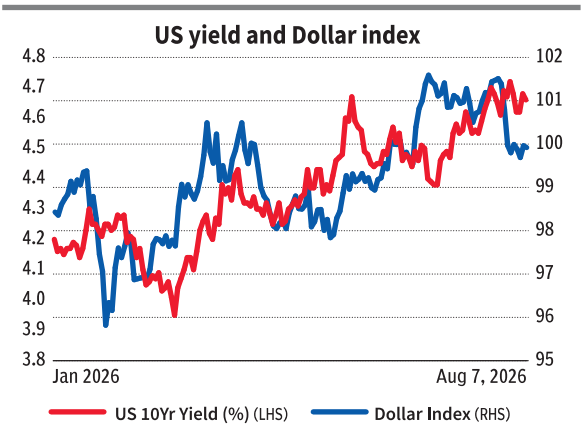
The yield has to decline below 4.45 per cent decisively in order to negate this bullish view. If that happens, we can get a fall to 4.3-4.2 per cent. In that case, the yield can sustain below 4.5 per cent.

But we expect the US 10Yr Treasury Yield to sustain above 4.5 per cent and rise to 5 per cent.

Here is our take on what the rise to 5 per cent on the yield will mean for other assets.

STRONG DOLLAR

The US dollar is likely to strengthen more, going forward, on the back of high yields. Barring the recent divergence, the



Source: Bloomberg

dollar index moves in tandem with the US 10Yr Treasury Yield (see the chart above). Indeed, the recent divergence is caused because of the sharp rise in the Japanese Yen on the back of the combined intervention by both the US and Japan. The Japanese Yen is the second highly weighted component in the Dollar index next to the Euro. The Yen has 13.6 per cent weightage in the dollar index. So, movement in the yen is significant for the dollar index.

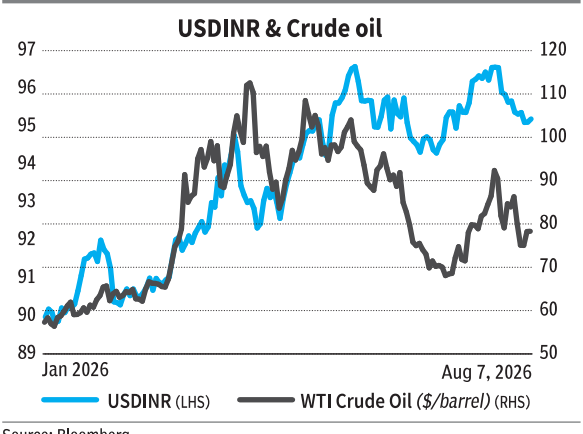
Based on the charts, the USDJPY (158) has a cluster of supports in the 155-150 region. We expect it to sustain above 150 and rise to 170 in the coming months. This suggests that downside in the dollar index could be limited.

The dollar index (99.60) has a good support around 98. Resistance is in the 101-102 region. We expect the dollar index to breach 102 and go up to 105-106 next year.

This view will go wrong if the index declines below 98. In that case, a fall to 96 can be seen and the index can remain in a range of 96-102.

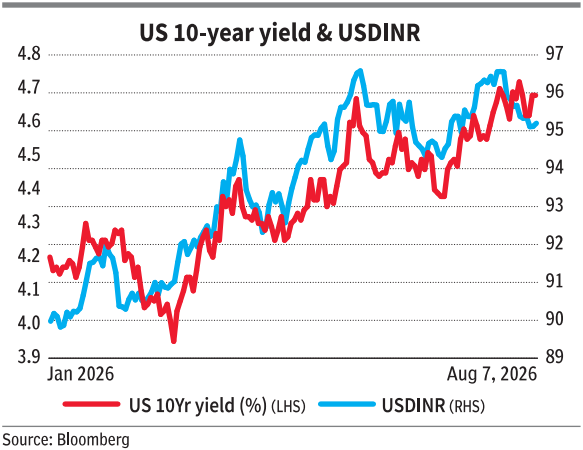
RUPEE: DOUBLE WHAMMY

The Indian Rupee has been under a huge pressure since the beginning of the US-Iran war. The spike in oil prices had dragged the domestic currency to a new low of 96.96 against the dollar. The price movement comparison (See Chart below) clearly shows that the recent fall in rupee has been triggered by the sharp rise in oil prices. So, unless oil price comes down below \$60, the rupee is unlikely to gain strength.



Source: Bloomberg

It is also interesting to see that similar to that of oil, the movement between the rupee and US 10Yr Yield also has a strong negative correlation (See Chart below). So, the rise in Yield to 5 per cent and elevated oil prices are going to be a double whammy for the Indian rupee.



Source: Bloomberg

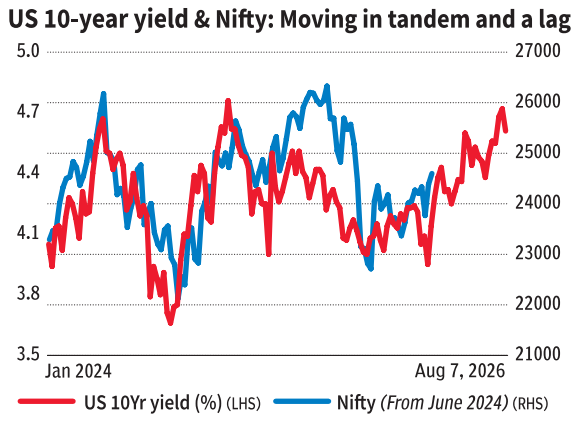
On the charts, rupee has strong resistances at 94.50 and 94. Though a rise to 94.50-94 is possible in the short term, a rise above 94 is unlikely.

Rupee is likely to reverse lower from the 94.50-94 region and fall back to 96-97 in the coming months.

From a big picture, the rupee is likely to breach 97 eventually and fall to 98 over the next two-three quarters.

LAGGING NIFTY

In general, the equity market is negatively correlated with the bond yields. A study between the movement in the US 10Yr Yield and the Nifty 50 shows that both move together but at different times. That is, Nifty moves in tandem with the US 10Yr Yield, but with a lag.



Source: Bloomberg

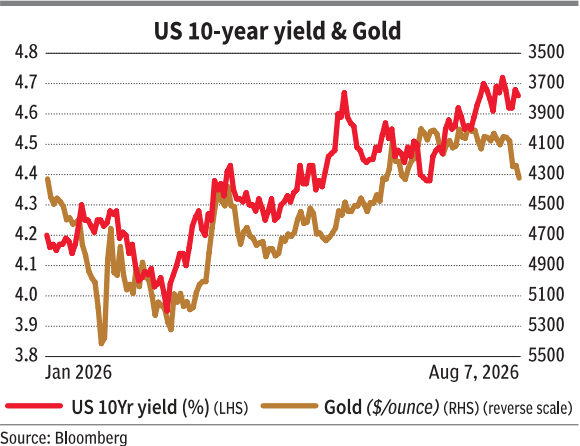
The chart below shows that the movement of Nifty from May 2024 is tracing the same path of the US 10Yr Yield from January 2024.

If this pattern continues, then Nifty can rise to 26,000 by this year-end. Also, the rise to 5 per cent in the US 10Yr Yield can then leave the doors open for the Nifty to hit new highs next year.

However, whenever the yields surge, they jolt the sentiment in the market. So, the possibility of the Nifty going to new highs might be accompanied by intermediate corrections.

GOLD: LESS GLITTER

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield and gold have an inverse correlation (See Chart below). So, if the 10Yr Yield goes up to 4.8 per cent and 5 per cent, then the upside in gold can be capped.



Source: Bloomberg

Gold (\$4,341 per ounce) has risen well last week from around \$4,000.

But this could be short-lived if the yields start to move up. Indeed, higher yields can even drag the gold price further lower from here.

From the charts, we expect the upside in gold to be capped at \$4,400-4,500. The downside remains open to see \$3,800-3,700.

TAKEAWAY

High oil prices and the prospects for interest rate hikes in the US are likely to push the US Treasury Yields higher. That, in turn, will keep the dollar strong.

Consequently, the rupee is likely to remain vulnerable for a fresh fall. Similarly, the upside in gold can be capped for some time now. The yellow metal has room to fall more.

Nifty, on the other hand, can be better poised if it continues to trace the earlier path of the US 10Yr Yield.

There can be some jolts in the interim if the rise in yields is quick.

Not all themes are tactical bets

RETURN REALITY. Two decades of rolling-return data show select thematic and sectoral mutual funds can reward patience, but cyclicalty and drawdowns still matter

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

For years, thematic mutual funds have been viewed as tactical bets rather than long-term investments. The common criticism is that their concentrated portfolios, built around a single theme, are vulnerable to long stretches of underperformance. Consequently, investors are advised to keep diversified funds at the core of their portfolios and use thematic funds only as tactical satellite holdings.

But is concentration itself the problem?

Even the Nifty 50, India's most-tracked benchmark, has often been heavily skewed towards a handful of sectors. Financials have frequently accounted for more than one-third of the index, while IT and energy have dominated during different market phases.

The key question is whether concentration necessarily leads to weaker long-term returns.

A *bl.portfolio* analysis of 10-year and 15-year rolling returns using two decades of NAV data suggests that it need not.

The flexi-cap category, which represents diversified active equity funds, delivered a worst-case (minimum) 10-year rolling return of 3 per cent and a minimum 15-year rolling return of 4 per cent. Surprisingly, eight of the 10 thematic categories recorded a higher minimum 10-year rolling return than the flexi-cap category. When the investment horizon was extended to 15 years, nine of the 10 categories recorded a higher minimum return on this downside measure.

HOW WE STUDIED?

We examined the 10-year and 15-year rolling returns of every thematic and sectoral fund with at least 20 years of NAV history. Of the 247 schemes in the broader universe, only 31 qualified. The core comparison covers 27 funds across 10 thematic and sectoral categories, while four other qualifying schemes were kept outside this comparison.

For each category, the minimum represents the lowest rolling return recorded by any qualifying scheme, the maximum the highest, and the mean the average of the schemes' mean rolling returns. These results were then compared with the flexi-cap category (11 schemes eligible), the clearest available proxy for diversified active equity funds. The study is timely, given the surge in launches of niche thematic offerings such as innovation, business cycles, ESG, manufacturing and quant investing. As investors gain access to increasingly specialised products, understanding their long-term risk-return profiles becomes critical.

KEY TRENDS

Several themes show stronger downside outcomes

One of the biggest myths surrounding thematic funds is that they inevitably lag diversified funds over the long run because of their concentrated portfolios. The rolling-return analysis tells a different story. The flexicap category delivered a worst-case 10-year rolling return of 3 per cent and a minimum 15-year rolling return of 4 per cent. Eight of the 10 thematic categories recorded a higher minimum 10-year rolling return, while nine recorded a higher minimum over 15 years.

The picture is more mixed when average returns are considered. Flexi-cap funds delivered an average 10-year

Average long-term returns: Thematic categories vs flexicap						
	10-year rolling return (%)			15-year rolling return (%)		
Theme	Lowest	Highest	Average	Lowest	Highest	Average
Commodities	0.8	19.0	10.9	5.4	15.4	10.3
Consumption	5.1	26.4	15.2	7.5	23.6	15.3
Ethical	7.1	20.0	13.0	8.3	19.3	13.2
Infrastructure	-2.2	21.1	11.1	3.1	18.9	11.1
MNC	6.7	25.7	15.0	9.6	21.4	14.8
Opportunities	5.0	19.8	13.3	7.2	19.1	13.3
Pharma & Health Care	8.1	24.7	15.1	11.7	24.2	16.6
Service Industry	8.8	22.9	15.3	9.5	21.7	15.2
Technology	4.3	27.2	15.9	10.8	26.3	16.3
Banks & Financial Serv	3.4	24.4	13.5	8.5	20.9	13.4
Flexicap funds	3.0	23.2	13.0	4.0	29.5	15.3

Based on 20 years of historical data. Returns represent rolling CAGR for the respective periods. Source: ACEMF

When themes fall out of favour, recovery can take years

Index	Underperformance period	Duration (years)
Nifty Infrastructure	Jan-2008 - Oct-2021	13.8
Nifty PSU Bank	Nov-2010 - Aug-2023	12.8
Nifty PSE	Jan-2008 - Jan-2017	9.0
Nifty Commodities	Jan-2008 - Jan-2017	9.0
Nifty Energy	Jan-2008 - Jan-2017	9.0
Nifty Smallcap 250	Jan-2008 - Jun-2014	6.4
Nifty Midcap 150	Jan-2008 - May-2014	6.4
Nifty500 Shariah	Jan-2008 - Oct-2013	5.8
Nifty Pharma	Apr-2015 - Jan-2021	5.8
Nifty Auto	Jan-2018 - Oct-2021	3.8
Nifty CPSE	Jan-2018 - Oct-2021	3.7
Nifty IT	Mar-2015 - Jan-2018	2.9
Nifty 50	Jan-2008 - Oct-2010	2.7
Nifty India Consumption	Jan-2008 - Sep-2010	2.7
Nifty Financial Services	Jan-2008 - Aug-2010	2.6
Nifty Private Bank	Jan-2008 - Aug-2010	2.6
Nifty Bank	Jan-2008 - Aug-2010	2.5
Nifty MNC	Aug-2018 - Nov-2020	2.2
Nifty FMCG	Sep-2024 - Aug-2026	1.9

Total return variant (TR) is considered. Source: ACEMF, Bloomberg

rolling return of 13 per cent, rising to 15.3 per cent over 15-year rolling periods. Against this benchmark, seven of the 10 thematic categories generated higher average 10-year rolling returns, while the Ethical category was effectively in line after rounding.

Over 15 years, only three categories were above the flexi-cap mean. Technology and Pharma & Healthcare were clearly ahead, while Consumption, at about 15.35 per cent, was only marginally above the 15.3 per cent flexi-cap return.

The findings suggest that thematic funds, as a group, are not inherently inferior to diversified funds. Several also exhibited stronger historical minimum outcomes, indicating that concentration did not necessarily translate into weaker long-term realised outcomes.

Takeaway: Investors should not automatically dismiss thematic funds as tactical products. Carefully selected themes have historically generated long-term returns and downside resilience comparable to, and in several cases better than, diversified equity funds.

Structural themes fared better than macro bets The analysis reveals a broad divide between structural-growth themes and macro-driven sectors.

Technology, Pharma & Healthcare, Consumption and Service Industry funds delivered average 10-year rolling returns of about 15.9 per cent, 15.1 per cent, 15.2 per cent and 15.3 per cent, respectively, compared with the flexi-cap category average of 13 per cent.

Over 15 years, however, the picture was less uniform. Technology and Pharma & Healthcare remained ahead of flexi-cap, Consumption was broadly in line, while Ser-



GETTY IMAGES

LONG VIEW

- Structural themes fared better than cyclical
- Longer horizons improved historical downside outcomes
- Fund selection matters within strong themes

ture remained behind at 3.1 per cent.

The uneven performance is consistent with the cyclical nature of these sectors. Their fortunes are closely tied to government capital expenditure, interest-rate cycles, commodity prices and global economic conditions, resulting in long boom-and-bust phases that can test investors' patience.

Takeaway: Not all thematic funds should be treated alike. Themes supported by long-term structural growth have historically produced stronger outcomes in this sample. In contrast, macro-sensitive sectors remain more cyclical and can require careful timing and a higher risk tolerance.

Longer horizons improved downside outcomes

The downside narrowed meaningfully as the investment horizon increased. Across almost every category, the worst historical outcome improved substantially when the holding period was extended from 10 years to 15 years.

Technology illustrates this well. The lowest 10-year rolling return was 4.3 per cent. The minimum 15-year rolling return was much higher at 10.8 per cent.

The same trend is visible across Infrastructure, Banking, Consumption, MNC, Opportunities and Service Industry funds. This is consistent with the benefit of allowing multiple business cycles to play out.

Takeaway: The data suggests thematic funds require a genuinely long investment horizon. But 15 years should not be treated as a magic threshold. Longer holding periods improved historical minimum outcomes, but did not eliminate theme-specific risk or guarantee strong returns.

Concentration isn't the only risk

The analysis challenges the idea that concentration alone determines long-term thematic-fund outcomes.

Technology and Pharma funds are among the most concentrated thematic categories studied, with portfolios largely confined to a single industry. Although these funds have expanded their investment universe within their sub-sectors over time, they have historically remained highly concentrated exposures.

Yet they delivered some of the strongest long-term outcomes, generating average

15-year rolling returns of more than 16 per cent, ahead of the flexicap category's 15.3 per cent. In contrast, Infrastructure funds, despite investing across a broader ecosystem of sectors including engineering, cement, capital goods, utilities and construction, delivered only around 11 per cent.

Takeaway: The contrast suggests that the breadth of sectors within a theme is not, by itself, a reliable guide to its long-term outcome. Investors should judge thematic funds by the durability of their underlying growth drivers rather than simply by the number of sectors they hold.

Wider dispersion within categories

Even within the strongest themes, outcomes varied. In the Consumption category, average 10-year rolling returns ranged from roughly 13 per cent to 18 per cent among schemes. Within Technology, the range was 15 per cent to 18 per cent.

Takeaway: Investors must evaluate individual funds based on the consistency of their rolling returns, sector weights within the theme and their ability to navigate inevitable downcycles.

Prolonged drawdowns

Beyond average returns, the length of time an index remains below its previous peak is a crucial consideration for long-term investors. This reflects one of the biggest risks associated with thematic investing: remaining below a previous peak for years.

An underwater analysis of major sectoral and thematic indices confirms that this

Long-term returns reveal both the opportunity and the risk

10-year and 15-year rolling returns (CAGR %) of thematic fund categories

Fund	Theme	10-year rolling return (%)			15-year rolling return (%)		
		Low	High	Average	Low	High	Average
Nippon India Banking & Fin Serv	Banks & Financial Services	5.2	24.4	14.9	11.5	20.9	15.0
UTI Banking and Fin Serv		3.4	21.4	12.1	8.5	17.5	11.9
SBI Comma	Commodities	0.8	19.0	10.9	5.4	15.4	10.3
Aditya Birla SL Consumption	Consumption	11.9	22.5	16.5	12.4	20.9	16.2
Nippon India Consumption		5.1	18.0	12.6	7.5	19.0	13.2
SBI Consumption Opp		12.3	26.4	18.0	15.3	23.6	19.1
Sundaram Consumption		7.9	20.9	13.7	7.5	18.7	12.8
Tata Ethical	Ethical	7.1	20.0	13.0	8.3	19.3	13.2
Aditya Birla SL Infrastructure	Infrastructure	1.1	19.1	11.6	6.1	18.0	11.6
Canara Rob Infrastructure		3.6	20.1	12.8	7.5	18.9	13.3
DSP India T.I.G.E.R		2.2	21.1	12.5	6.6	18.1	12.6
ICICI Pru Infrastructure		0.5	20.9	11.6	7.0	17.3	12.2
Sundaram Infra Advantage		-2.2	18.9	9.3	3.1	15.2	8.8
Tata Infrastructure		1.1	20.7	11.0	5.4	16.9	10.9
UTI Infrastructure		-0.3	17.6	9.0	3.4	13.3	8.7
Aditya Birla SL MNC	MNC	6.7	25.7	15.5	12.1	19.8	15.0
SBI MNC		8.9	24.8	14.6	9.6	21.4	14.4
UTI MNC		8.1	23.2	15.0	12.4	19.1	15.0
Franklin India Opportunities	Opportunities	5.0	19.8	13.3	7.2	19.1	13.3
Nippon India Pharma	Pharma & Health Care	10.6	24.7	17.1	15.5	24.2	18.5
SBI Healthcare Opp		9.8	22.8	14.8	11.7	22.9	16.2
UTI Healthcare		8.1	17.6	13.5	12.3	19.0	15.0
ICICI Pru Exports & Services	Service industry	8.8	22.9	15.3	9.5	21.7	15.2
Aditya Birla SL Digital India	Technology	4.3	24.3	15.3	10.8	21.9	15.2
Franklin India Technology		6.6	22.5	15.0	11.6	22.7	15.5
ICICI Pru Technology		8.5	27.2	17.8	14.1	26.3	18.5
SBI Technology Opp		4.9	24.6	15.6	11.1	24.2	16.1

Based on 20 years of historical data. Returns represent rolling CAGR for the respective periods. Period ended Aug 6, 2026. Source: ACEMF

A bl.portfolio compilation

concern is valid. The Nifty Infrastructure Index remained below its previous peak for nearly 14 years. The Nifty PSU Bank index required almost 13 years to recover, while the Nifty PSE, Commodities and Energy indices each spent around nine years underwater.

Takeaway: Such long drawdowns create a major behavioural challenge for thematic investors. Prolonged periods without regaining a previous peak can push investors to abandon a theme before a subsequent recovery. Time does not automatically heal every thematic drawdown. Investors should be particularly wary of themes whose historical recovery periods have stretched into a decade or more.

CONCLUSION

The conventional perception that thematic funds are unsuitable for long-term investing deserves a rethink.

Technology and Pharma &

Healthcare stand out in the analysis.

Both generated average rolling returns above flexicap over 10-year and 15-year periods and also recorded stronger historical minimum returns.

Consumption also performed well, beating flexicap on average over 10 years and remaining broadly in line over 15 years. MNC funds, meanwhile, recorded stronger historical minimum returns, although their average 15-year return was slightly below that of flexicap funds.

At the same time, the study reinforces that not all themes are created equal. Infrastructure and Commodities lagged flexicap funds on average returns over both horizons. Energy & Power, which was outside the core 10-category comparison, also lagged flexicap on average.

These themes also featured among indices with some of the longest historical

underwater periods. This highlights the fact that extending the investment horizon alone cannot overcome a weak or highly cyclical investment theme.

In this sample, themes linked to longer-term trends such as digitalisation, rising healthcare spending and consumption generally produced stronger long-term outcomes, whereas sectors dependent heavily on capital expenditure, commodity prices or economic cycles produced more uneven results.

For investors, the implication is more nuanced than simply treating all thematic funds as tactical bets. Carefully selected structural themes can serve as long-term satellite holdings alongside a diversified core.

But the data does not make a case for replacing diversified funds with thematic bets; it shows that the quality and durability of the underlying theme matter as much as concentration itself.

MEDI ASSIST HEALTHCARE SERVICES LIMITED				
CIN: L74900MH2000PLC437885				
Registered Office: AARPEE Chambers, SSRP Building, 7 th Floor, Andheri Kurla Road, Marol Co-operative Industrial Estate Road, Gamdevi, Marol, Andheri East, Marol Bazar, Mumbai - 400 059. Phone: +91 - 22 - 6259 6797				
Corporate Office: Tower D, 4 th Floor, IBC Knowledge Park, 4/1 Bannerghatta Road, Bengaluru - 560029 Phone: +91-80-6919 0000 Email: investor.relations@mediassist.in Website: www.mediassist.in				
STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026				
(₹ in Millions)				
Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended
		June 30, 2026	March 31, 2026	June 30, 2025
		(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)
1	Total Income from Operations	2,365.19	2,419.86	1,905.58
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	349.07	279.04	305.12
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	349.07	279.04	305.12
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax from continuing operations (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	275.97	544.77	226.31
5	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax from continuing operations and discontinued operations (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	275.97	544.77	226.31
6	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	286.93	520.85	238.13
7	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value of ₹ 5/- each)	373.51	373.05	352.69
8	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year			8,015.98
9	Earnings Per Share (EPS) (of ₹ 5/- each) (from continuing and discontinued operations)	5.00	5.00	5.00
	1. Basic	3.71	7.33	3.18
	2. Diluted	3.71	7.33	3.16
Notes:				
Standalone Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026				
Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended
		June 30, 2026	March 31, 2026	June 30, 2025
		(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)
1	Revenue from contracts with customers	589.84	635.63	437.04
2	Profit/ (Loss) before tax (before exceptional items)	176.99	193.99	108.53
3	Profit/ (Loss) before tax (after exceptional items)	176.99	193.99	108.53
4	Profit/ (Loss) after tax from continuing operations	131.52	144.97	80.20
5	Profit/ (Loss) after tax from continuing operations and discontinued operations	131.52	144.97	80.20
The above unaudited consolidated financial results of Medi Assist Healthcare Services Limited ("the Holding Company" or "the Company"), its subsidiaries have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors, at their meetings held on August 08, 2026. These unaudited consolidated financial results have been subjected to limited review by the statutory auditors of the Company and they have issued an unmodified report on these unaudited consolidated financial results.				
The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) i.e., www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com and the Company at www.mediassist.in/investor-relations/. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.				
During the quarter ended June 30, 2026, the paid-up equity share capital of the Company has increased from ₹ 373.047 millions to ₹ 373.509 millions, pursuant to exercise of stock options by certain employees and allotment of 92,415 equity shares thereon.				
Date : August 08, 2026 Place : Mumbai		For MEDI ASSIST HEALTHCARE SERVICES LIMITED Sd/- Satish V N Gidugu CEO & Whole-Time Director (DIN: 06643677)		

Harness it for the long term

IPO WATCH. The public issue of Dhoot Transmission is open for subscription from August 10-12

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl, research bureau

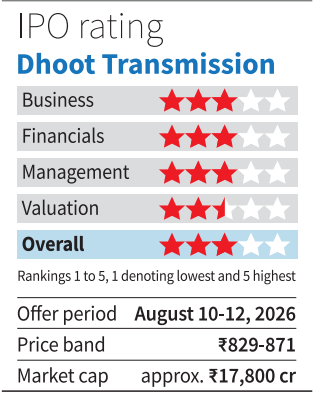
The IPO of automotive wiring harness supplier Dhoot Transmission (DTL) is open for subscription from August 10-12. The ₹3,067-crore issue includes a fresh issue worth ₹1,400 crore and an offer for sale (OFS) worth ₹1,667 crore. A group entity of American private equity firm Bain Capital, which currently controls 55 per cent of the stake in DTL and another promoter group entity are set to offload 8.5 per cent and 1.65 per cent of pre-IPO stake in the OFS. Following the issue, the promoter and promoter group's stake is expected to decline to 82.8 per cent from nearly 100 per cent currently. Of the ₹1,400 crore raised, DTL aims to utilise ₹767 crore to fully pay down debt, ₹150 crore to expand wiring harness capacity and the rest to fund acquisitions and general corporate purposes.

At the upper end of the price band, the IPO values DTL at a market cap of ₹17,816 crore or 43x adjusted FY26 earnings. This is comparable with listed peers Motherson Sumi Wiring (MSW) and Minda Corporation, but fares better on growth, margin and balance sheet strength.

While valuation is in line with peers, it is not inexpensive *per se*. However, given DTL's recent growth and its ability to benefit from the electrification of India's vehicle fleet, investors with high risk appetite and a long-term perspective can consider subscribing to the IPO. Also, we would like investors to take note of details discussed under 'Deals with Bain'.

BUSINESS
DTL is a supplier of electrical and electronic components for automotive applications. It designs, manufactures and sells wiring harnesses, sensors & controllers (such as side stand position sensor, ABS wheel speed sensor, temperature sensor) and automotive switches (push button switches, ON/OFF rocker switches, rotary switches, etc.). Besides, it also assembles battery packs for EVOEMs.

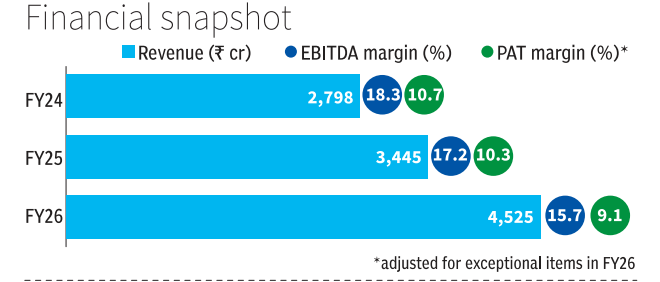
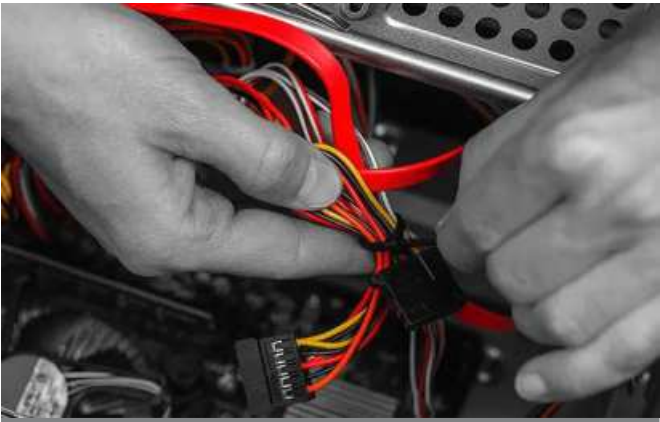
Wiring harnesses make about



80 per cent of revenue (77 per cent in FY26) and other products account for the rest. DTL commands a market share of 38 per cent in 2W wiring harnesses and over 70 per cent in those for 3Ws. MSW and Minda Corporation are other major suppliers. However, MSW largely supplies to 4Ws, with only about 12 per cent of its ₹11,478-crore revenue derived from 2Ws. Minda Corp is a diversified player with wiring harness accounting for 31 per cent of its ₹6,185-crore revenue.

In FY26, DTL derived 90 per cent of its revenue from India and the rest overseas. End-market wise, it derived 65 per cent and 13 per cent of revenue from 2Ws and 3Ws respectively and the rest from commercial & off-highway vehicles and overseas business. The product portfolio is almost entirely powertrain-agnostic.. About 24 per cent of revenue is from EV applications and the rest from ICE.

WHAT NUMBERS SAY
DTL's revenue and net profit have grown at strong CAGRs of 27 per cent and 17 per cent over FY24-26. It earns an EBITDA margin in the range of 15-17 per cent, higher than MSW's 9-12 per cent and Minda Corp's 11-12 per cent (FY24-26). Per the management, the margin decline in FY26 was due to commodity inflation towards the end of the year. However, based on how the industry works, margin can reasonably be expected to rebound as customer compensation typically follows with a lag after DTL first absorbs the inflation. Tangible fixed assets



How peers compare

	Revenue CAGR (%)*	PAT CAGR (%)*	EBITDA margin (%)**	Net debt to EBITDA (x)**	P/E (x)	P/B (x)
DTL	27	17	15.7	-0.3	43	7.3
MSW	17	-1	9.2	0.2	44	12.6
Minda Corp	15	26	11.7	1.2	48	6.5
Uno Minda	18	21	12.7	1.0	58	11.0
Sona BLW	19	11	24.9	-0.9	80	8.6

Peers as identified by the RHP. Yet MSW and Minda Corp are more comparable peers.
*FY24-26 **FY26
Source: RHP

turnover ratio stood at 3.7x for FY26 and RoCE at 19.2 per cent. RoCE is down from 33.6 per cent in FY24 largely because of a ₹2,000-odd crore equity infusion by promoter BC Asia XV (a Bain Capital entity) in FY26. DTL, which had a net-debt to equity of 0.8x as of FY25, turned net debt free as of FY26, by virtue of the same capital infusion.

WHAT WORKS
DTL is well placed to benefit from the electrification of India's vehicle fleet and the growing adoption of connected vehicle technologies, including advanced driver assistance systems (ADAS). Simply put, these imply the use of more wires and sensors. Per the prospectus, wiring content in an electric 2W (e-2W) can be 1.5-

2.5x that of an ICE vehicle. e-2W and e-3W sales growth is expected to outpace the overall 2W and 3W sales growth. This is driven by lower total cost of ownership (lifetime cost) and government policy continuing to favour EVs — GST at 5 per cent versus 18 per cent/40 per cent on ICE, for instance, besides other incentives.

Per a Crisil report in the RHP, EV penetration (as a percentage of annual sales) in 2Ws, has risen to 6.6 per cent by FY26. It now stands at a higher 9.7 per cent for FY27 year-to-date and is expected to reach 40 per cent by FY30. Adoption is significantly higher in 3Ws at 31.6 per cent (FY26). While the projections may not exactly materialise, the direction towards electrification should be the takeaway. All this means that

the domestic wiring harness market (for 2W, 3W, trucks) is pegged to grow at a CAGR of 12-14 per cent over FY26-31, while that for EVs is expected to grow at a quicker clip of 33-35 per cent.

DTL's battery pack business could ride the growth in sale of EVs. Besides, it plans to foray into power electronics which include chargers and DC-DC converters for e-2Ws, e-3Ws, e-4Ws and e-trucks. The company is also looking at inorganic growth opportunities. It has recently concluded the acquisition of Multilink, a supplier of fuel level sensors and relays, at ₹421 crore. It has also established a JV with Israel-based Ride Vision for the supply of ADAS systems. All these serve as growth levers in addition to expanding wallet share with existing customers.

DEALS WITH BAIN
As said earlier, Bain Capital (through BC Asia XV) has invested ₹1,977 crore in DTL via private placements — one in April 2025 and the other in March 2026. This is on top of a secondary market purchase of shares from the promoter in April 2025, resulting in BC Asia XV gaining a stake of 55 per cent. BC Asia XV's weighted average cost per share after adjusting for stock splits and bonuses works out to about ₹480. At the IPO price, BC Asia XV would've sold 8.5 per cent of its pre-IPO stake at a substantially higher ₹871 per share. The fact that the asking price has gone up over 80 per cent in a matter of 16 months is to be noted. Shares of peers (see table) are up anywhere between 21 and 76 per cent in the same period.

Separately, DTL had engaged Bain Capital Advisors (India) to obtain consulting services on acquisitions besides day-to-day operations in April 2025. The deal entails payment of about ₹12 crore a year for five years. However, under the deal terms, if DTL completes an IPO before the end of the five-year term, it must pay Bain Capital Advisors an upfront ₹60 crore, less any amount already paid (₹12 crore paid in FY26). This means that post the IPO, DTL would shell out ₹48 crore to honour this deal.

Look before you LEAP

IPO WATCH. Dominant pooling franchise and debt reduction cannot offset the aggressive valuation for LEAP India

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, research bureau

On-demand asset-pooling provider LEAP India, backed by private equity giant KKR, has come to the IPO market with a ₹2,480-crore IPO at a price band of ₹151-159 per share. The public issue closes August 11. Thirteen-year-old LEAP India owns pallets (flat wooden platforms used to move heavy loads), reusable containers and material-handling equipment, and rents them to companies. The physical product is simple, but the network around it is not. LEAP has built scale through acquisitions, particularly Skan Marine and CHEP India, high utilisation, technology-led asset tracking and a dominant position (90 per cent market share) in India's organised pallet-pooling market.

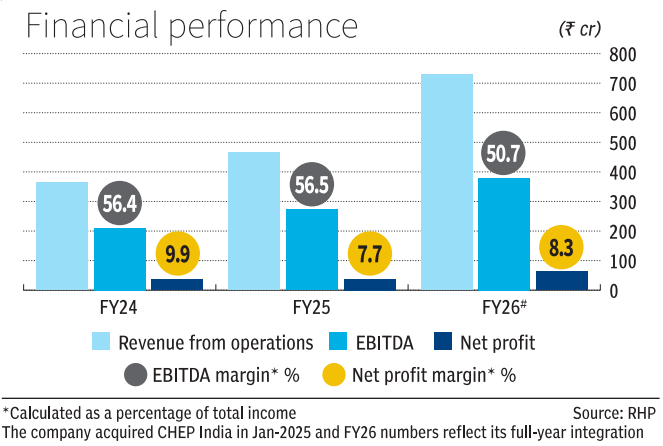
The January 2025 acquisition of CHEP India, then its largest organised competitor, boosted this position further.

After accounting for the fresh issue and proposed debt repayment, the enterprise value works out to about ₹7,700-7,800 crore, or around 20-20.5 times FY26 EBITDA.

This is demanding for a company whose recent growth is substantially acquisition-led, FY26 return on equity was only 6.48 per cent and business requires continuous capital expenditure. LEAP is available for 112x trailing P/E and about nearly 7x price to book.

The IPO is heavily tilted towards promoter monetisation, with a ₹2,000-crore OFS against a fresh issue of only ₹480 crore. KKR-controlled Vertical Holdings II accounts for nearly the entire OFS.

The gross OFS proceeds are about 93 per cent of KKR entities' estimated aggregate investment in LEAP made less than 3 years ago, even as KKR retains a sizeable holding. The promoter and promoter group's combined holding will decline from 90 per cent pre-IPO to about 55.4 per cent post-IPO. Of the fresh proceeds from



IPO, ₹360 crore will repay debt. This could reduce annual interest costs for LEAP by ₹28-34 crore and boost profit. Yet, after allowing for a full year of interest savings and post-issue dilution, the stock would still trade at roughly 80-84 times earnings and about 20 times EV/EBITDA at ₹159/share.

Selected global pallet and asset-handling companies such as Cabka, AJ Networks, UFPI and Brambles trade at about 5-15 times trailing EV/EBITDA (20-25x P/E), though none is a perfect comparable.

LEAP's faster growth may warrant a premium, but its acquisition-led expansion, negative free cash flow and modest return ratios make the present valuation difficult to justify.

With the business model still new to public markets and in-

dustry dynamics yet to be tested through cycles, investors can wait and watch for now.

BUSINESS
A pallet is the platform on which cartons or industrial goods are stacked so that forklifts can move them. Large manufacturers may need thousands across factories, warehouses, distributors and retailers. Owning them involves upfront expenditure, seasonal idle capacity and recovery after delivery. LEAP addresses this through pooling. It owns the assets and allows multiple customers to use the same pool repeatedly. A food company, for example, can order pallets, load goods and send them to a retailer's warehouse. LEAP earns rent while the pallets remain deployed and



may also earn movement-related charges. After unloading, the pallets are collected, inspected, repaired where necessary and redeployed.

Rental rates are negotiated separately and are not disclosed. Pallets contributed 62.2 per cent of operating revenue. On the whole, leasing and rental services together contributed 93.4 per cent.

The company also rents reusable containers and material-handling equipment such as forklifts. Its 1,000+ customers span food and beverages, consumer goods, automotive, industrials, third-party logistics and e-commerce.

For customers, LEAP's offerings are asset-light. For LEAP, it is capital-intensive. The company owns 1.47 crore revenue-generating assets and must keep purchasing, tracking, transporting, repairing and replacing them.

Profitability, therefore, depends heavily on utilisation. FY26 pallet utilisation was 89.34 per cent, while container and material-handling equipment utilisation stood at 71.68 per cent and 79.79 per cent, respectively.

Its 29 fulfilment centres, 10,100-plus customer touchpoints and recovery network are genuine competitive advantages.

Its one-to-five-year contracts permit periodic escalation and recovery of certain cost increases, while customers compensate it for specified asset losses and damage.

FINANCIALS
Revenue from operations rose from about ₹365 crore in FY24 to about ₹730 crore in FY26, while EBITDA increased from about ₹210 crore to about ₹379 crore. PAT rose from about ₹37 crore to ₹62 crore, and the asset pool expanded from 79.2 lakh to 1.47 crore units.

However, headline growth overstates organic momentum. LEAP acquired CHEP India for about ₹1,004 crore in January 2025. FY26 included a full year of acquired operations.

The 56 per cent jump in FY26 revenue therefore reflects consolidation as well as underlying growth and should not be extrapolated mechanically.

The acquisition transformed the balance sheet. Total borrowings rose from ₹513 crore in FY24 to ₹1,018 crore in FY26, while annual finance costs reached about ₹94 crore. Borrowings stood at roughly ₹1,023 crore by June 2026; the proposed ₹360-crore repayment should reduce them to about ₹663 crore.

The larger concern is capital intensity. LEAP generated operating cash flow of ₹268 crore in FY26, but capital expenditure was about ₹390 crore, leaving free cash flow after capex negative.

Cash conversion also needs watching. Average receivable days remained high at 131 in FY26, though they improved from 156 days in FY25.

Depreciation, amortisation and impairment amounted to about ₹204 crore in FY26. LEAP assumes a 15-year economic useful life for pallets. EBITDA margin declined from 56.4 per cent in FY24 to 50.7 per cent in FY26, while PAT margin slipped a bit from 10 per cent to 8.3 per cent.

Despite the high EBITDA margin, depreciation and interest absorb much of operating profit, leaving ROE modest.

LEAP may compound well over the long term. But the IPO price captures much of tomorrow's promise upfront.

Thus, investors can wait and watch.

GLOBAL BOARDROOM CHATTER.

What they say on their India plans

With India being the fastest growing large economy, 'what is your India plan?' is a common topic in boardrooms of most global corporations. One important source to distil their India plans is from their quarterly earnings calls. This column will present what CXOs of global corporations are saying about India, along with their perspectives and plans during the current earnings season. With the June quarter earnings season in progress, here are some from companies that reported their earnings last week.

CNH Industrial N.V. (CNH, m-cap \$13.6 billion)
The agricultural equipment manufacturer continues to gain share in India, retaining its position as the country's fastest-growing tractor brand and strengthening its ability to compete with Indian manufacturers globally. "India has been a major success story for us. We were the fastest-growing tractor brand in India last year and remain the fastest-growing brand year-to-date in 2026. Winning in this highly competitive, high-volume market demonstrates our ability to compete effectively with Indian manufacturers and their exports globally."

Kimberly-Clark Corporation (KMB, \$36.1 billion)
The consumer products company sees India as one of its strongest growth markets, with the pending Kenvue acquisition potentially quadrupling local distribution and accelerating premiumisation. "India is one of our strongest growth stories, and Kenvue has the potential to quadruple our distribution. We are also seeing consumers willing to pay for superior products when we address real needs, particularly within Huggies, reinforcing the opportunity for premiumisation and long-term growth."

Ball Corporation (BALL, \$16.8 billion)
The packaging major sees India as a significant long-term growth market for beverage cans and is adding further capacity after an earlier expansion. "India remains a major opportunity, with can demand growing at a strong double-digit rate. We have announced another capacity expansion at one of our two Indian plants, building on capacity already added. Government policy changes and continued market growth support an attractive long-term outlook."

Cummins Inc. (CMI, \$89.3 billion)
The engine manufacturer reported continued growth in India, supported by freight, infrastructure and mining activity, while maintaining its 2026 revenue growth outlook. "India revenue, including joint ventures, grew 6 per cent to \$742 million in Q2, while truck production increased 5 per cent, supported by freight availability, infrastructure and mining activity. We continue to expect India revenue to grow 2 per cent in 2026, with truck demand broadly flat but supported by tax reductions and improving underlying demand."

Glencore plc (GLEN, £67.3 billion)
The diversified miner remains confident in India's long-term coal import demand, supported by rapid economic growth, new coal-fired generation and rising power requirements from industries such as data centres. "India remains highly energy-hungry as its economy expands, with new coal-fired power stations and data centres increasing electricity requirements. Even as domestic Coal India production grows, the country will continue to require imported coal alongside renewables and other energy sources. We remain comfortable with India's long-term demand profile."



Heineken N.V. (HEIA, €43.0 billion)
The global brewer reported high-single-digit volume growth in India, supported by its market leadership, nationwide brewery network and strong premium growth. "India volumes grew high single-digit, with premium growth led by Kingfisher Ultra and Heineken Silver. Our scale and extensive network of owned and long-term contract breweries provide a strong competitive position. While passing through input-cost

inflation requires State-by-State pricing discussions, India remains a high-growth beer market."

Siemens Energy AG (ENR, €131.5 billion)
The energy technology major increased its stake in Siemens Energy India to 16 per cent, reinforcing its exposure to what it considers one of the world's most attractive energy infrastructure growth markets. "We increased our stake in Siemens Energy India by 1.02 per cent through the final share-swap and acquired another 3.98 per cent from Siemens AG for €428 million, taking our ownership to 16 per cent. The transaction was structured within India's 5 per cent annual acquisition threshold and further strengthens our position in this attractive growth market."

Iron Mountain Incorporated (IRM, \$37.5 billion)
The data centre and information management company sees India as a major growth market, supported by a large Mumbai lease and 100 MW of future hyperscale development capacity. "India is rapidly becoming a major hyperscale data centre market, where we have another 100 MW of future development capacity. Our broader India business is also performing exceptionally well, and the major lease recently signed in Mumbai demonstrates our comprehensive approach to what we see as a significant multi-year growth opportunity."

Eli Lilly and Company (LLY, \$1.10 trillion)
The pharmaceutical major said Mounjaro continues to gain prescriptions in India despite the entry of generic semaglutide, supported by the drug's clinical differentiation. "In India, Mounjaro continues to deliver prescription growth even after the launch of generic semaglutide. We believe this resilience is driven by the product's strong differentiation and superiority data, which remains our first line of defence against generic competition."

Warrior Met Coal, Inc. (HCC, \$4.7 billion)
The steelmaking coal producer continues to see resilient demand from India despite weak steel margins, contrasting with continued softness in China. "India demand remained resilient, growing 2.7 per cent year-over-year. The CFR India LVHCC index averaged \$191 per short tonne in Q2, up \$46 or 32 per cent from a year earlier, contrasting with continued weakness in China."

Henkel AG & Co. KGaA (HEN3, €32.3 billion)
The consumer and industrial products company is expanding its innovation footprint in India to capture growth in the country's fast-growing electronics market. "We recently opened a new electronics co-innovation and application centre in India, strengthening our ability to support customers in one of the world's fastest-growing electronics markets. The investment expands our innovation capabilities, shortens innovation cycles and positions us for long-term growth."

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

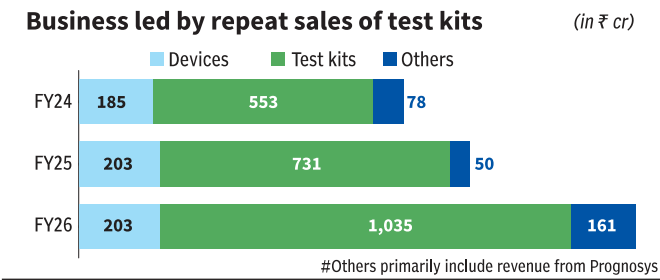
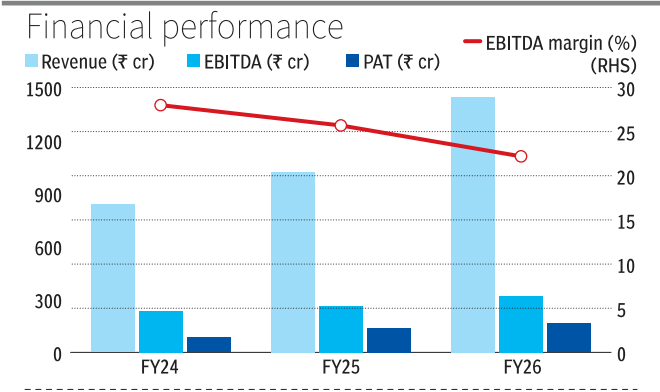
Molbio is a point-of-care technology (POCT) diagnostics company whose IPO is open from August 10-12. The company developed Truenat, a POCT polymerase chain reaction (PCR) platform for molecular diagnosis of 40 diseases currently, including TB, hepatitis, HIV and HPV. With revenue and PAT growing at CAGR of 31 per cent and 40 per cent, respectively, during FY24-26, the fast-growing company has strong drivers to sustain growth over the next few years.

The IPO consists of a fresh issue of ₹200 crore (primarily for capital expenditure and R&D) and an OFS portion of ₹739 crore. At the upper price band, the IPO is valued at 56.6 times FY26 earnings or 29 times EV/EBITDA, which is comparable to peers in diagnostics. While valuation is not cheap, long-term investors with a high risk appetite can subscribe to Molbio given its strong R&D capability, a growing Truenat platform and several growth drivers compared to other diagnostics which have to rely on retail volumes and store expansion for growth.

The Truenat platform, the main product, comprises two portable instruments. The device for nucleic acid extraction and Truelab analyser, which conducts real-time PCR tests. The tests use a disease-specific Truenat test-kits, which are single-use consumables pre-loaded with necessary reagents. The test portfolio consists of 40 infectious diseases currently and can be expanded on the same platform. Compared to smear test (patient's sputum sample is stained and viewed under a microscope), which is the earlier method, this device is portable, implying last-mile reach at primary healthcare centres. It is accurate too, owing to genetic testing and is a confirmatory diagnosis compared to smear test that requires further confirmation. The device can also detect low level of pathogens and is an early indicator. Compared to smear tests which take 7-10 days, Truenat platform delivers results in one hour.

GROWTH DRIVERS

Demographic factors and continued adoption should support good demand for the Truenat platform in India and other markets. The company has sold 12,500 devices in over 90 countries since 2020 — primarily in India and also in Africa, Bangladesh and Nigeria. TB testing has seen a

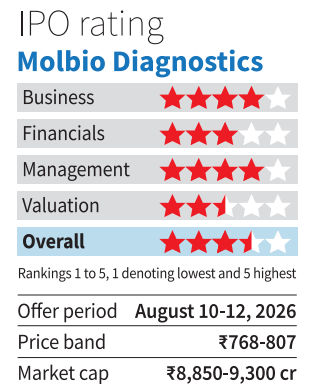


significant shift from smear tests to molecular platforms owing to portability, accuracy and turnaround time. Adoption of molecular diagnostics in India has also increased from 7 per cent in 2018 to 18 per cent in 2026. The rising disease burden and the solution Molbio offers in diagnosis, particularly in TB, is also a factor driving growth. India accounts for about 25 per cent of global TB cases, with nearly 2.7 million new cases each year in India and 10 million globally.

The 12,500-device count compares with 94,000 primary health centres (or equivalent) in target countries including 33,000 in In-

dia. This implies a long runway for adoption of the platform. The company is in an oligopoly (one competitor) and in a market with high barriers for entry. It developed the product for 13 years before approval from ICMR in India and being endorsed by WHO for complete replacement of smear testing for TB diagnosis, — this acts as a strong technological barrier.

In developed markets where there are lower number of TB patients, the Truenat platform finds application through testing for other diseases like STI diagnosis (sexually transmitted diseases) and Hepatitis. The company has



secured European CE mark approval for two conditions (chlamydia/gonorrhea) and will start commercialisation process in Europe.

Molbio has a strong R&D team, with close to 11 per cent of the 1,225 employees in March 2026 being scientists. The company and subsidiaries have registered 16 patents in India and 191 patents internationally to protect their development. It will supplement the 40-test portfolio with the 22 tests in development pipeline. In addition, the platform has played a significant role in diagnosis for Covid, swine flu and Nipah virus outbreaks.

ACQUISITIONS AND DEVELOPED MARKETS

Molbio has completed two acquisitions. In March 2023, the company acquired 70 per cent of Prognosis for around ₹45 crore. The acquired business manufactures digital imaging solutions such as ultraportable X-ray systems, mobile digital X-ray sys-

tems and others. The subsidiary recently has secured European approval for the portfolio and US FDA approval for portable X-ray machines, both for human and animal healthcare.

Molbio also acquired 60 per cent shareholding in the US-based OptraScan for \$30 million in November 2025. OptraScan, in early phase of development, provides digital pathology solutions, by scanning the slides that go into a microscope and digitally enhancing them along with an AI layer on top, replacing the need for microscopes. It also enables telepathology, eliminating bulky physical records for remote diagnosis. Molbio has received US FDA approval in July 2026 and it is likely to explore European approval as well.

The two subsidiaries present strong opportunities for growth in the US and European markets, but are in early stages of commercialisation.

FINANCIALS

Molbio reported revenue of ₹1,445 crore in FY26 and PAT of ₹164 crore. The revenue consists of devices (14 per cent of revenues) and test-kits (72 per cent), as shown in the figure. The 12 per cent CAGR growth of devices sold in FY24-26 has resulted in 41 per cent CAGR growth for test-kits. The devices sold contributes to a strong repeat business from sale of test-kits. As the number of diseases covered increases and end-users scale up on the adoption of tests, the high growth of test-kits should sustain, even as devices continue with relatively-modest growth.

The company has a good EBITDA margin of 22 per cent in FY26, which is calculated after accounting for R&D costs of 6-7 per cent per year. The margins have declined 600 bps from FY24, which it attributes to the product mix. The product mix has tilted towards higher test volume markets, which led to margin compression. This aspect can be monitored after listing. Despite the margin compression, the company reported strong earnings CAGR of 40 per cent over FY24-26.

Investor need to take note of two factors and monitor the risks. Governments and international aid agencies accounted for 85 per cent of revenues in FY26. Despite the high concentration, this is to be expected in public health diagnostics. Also, in FY26, 96 per cent of the tests conducted on the Truenat platform were for TB diagnosis. The company has to diversify this risk with new disease profile in the pipeline.

Taking Stock • bl • 5

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 My founder is a first-generation entrepreneur who began as a commodities trader and then went into manufacturing.
- 2 One of my competitors, whose products are promoted by one of India's best-known couple, accused me of using his registered brand name.
- 3 I have more than one lakh shareholders even though domestic institutions own more than half the free float.
- 4 My founder's family is worth more than a couple of billion dollars, while my entire market capitalisation was less than a billion dollars just three years ago.
- 5 My stock price is currently near an all-time high, having grown at a 20 per cent CAGR over the last five years.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

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Investing With Conviction
Last week's stock:
India Nippon Electricals
Last week's winner:
Krishna Prasath

How sectoral indices moved

	July 31	August 7	Movement	% change
METALS	40,935.6	42,153.1	▲	3.0
CAPITAL GOODS	77,012.2	79,282.7	▲	2.9
AUTO	63,263.4	65,073.8	▲	2.9
IT	29,502.3	30,304.5	▲	2.7
PSU	20,676.6	21,096.0	▲	2.0
TECK	15,627.4	15,832.2	▲	1.3
HEALTHCARE	50,797.0	51,234.8	▲	0.9
BANKEX	64,933.6	65,492.2	▲	0.9
FMCG	18,316.7	18,473.7	▲	0.9
POWER	7,668.8	7,660.7	▼	-0.1
CONSUMER DURABLES	65,145.6	64,972.9	▼	-0.3
OIL&GAS	26,484.2	26,349.2	▼	-0.5
REALTY	7,033.7	6,911.4	▼	-1.7

How other indices moved

NIFTY NEXT 50	73,651.3	74,697.6	▲	1.4
NIFTY 500	23,460.7	23,712.1	▲	1.1
NIFTY 100	25,486.4	25,712.7	▲	0.9
NIFTY 200	14,106.3	14,231.1	▲	0.9
BANK NIFTY	57,264.9	57,746.5	▲	0.8

Premium valuation, but creamy prospects too

IPO WATCH. A successful IPO will leave Milky Mist with a strong balance-sheet to tap growth opportunities

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Value-added dairy product company Milky Mist, famous in South India for its paneer (cottage cheese), comes to the market with a ₹1,553-crore IPO at ₹133-140 a share. At the upper end, the post-issue market capitalisation is about ₹10,778 crore for the Erode (TN)-based company backed by Temasek (pre-IPO in April 2026) and other investors such as Grand Anicut Fund – 1 (2020), Pratithi Growth Fund etc.

The IPO comprises a ₹1,428-crore fresh issue and ₹125-crore OFS (by promoters); of the fresh proceeds, ₹496.86 crore is earmarked for debt repayment, ₹469.24 crore for expanding and modernising the Perundurai (Erode district in TN) facility, and ₹155.31 crore for deploying visco-coolers, ice-cream freezers and chocolate coolers, with the balance for general corporate purposes.

The valuation is demanding. At ₹140/share, Milky Mist is asking for about 84.9 times P/E and 25.3 times EV/EBITDA based on FY26 numbers. This is at a rich premium to Bloomberg-reported 57 times P/E and 18.7 times EV/EBITDA for Hatsun Agro. The latter is nearly 3x size compared to revenue/profit and has different revenue mix (half from milk).

Milky Mist largely stays away from the low-margin liquid-milk business and focusses on value-added products. Its FY24-26 revenue CAGR was 31.3 per cent, signifying fast growth. PAT has grown over 550 per cent in the same period, due to small starting base. Its FY26 EBITDA margin at 13.9 per cent is higher than many packed foods industry peers and Hatsun Agro (12 per cent). Pre-IPO return ratios (RoCE, RoE) have shown fast ramp-up in the last two years.

While pre-IPO total debt at ₹1,672 crore may appear high,

chiefly due to over ₹1,300-crore capex in FY24-26, about 30 per cent reduction is on the cards due to repayment plans for high-interest rate private loans. A successful IPO will dramatically alter balance-sheet strength for the better and position it well in a competitive industry. Inflow of fresh issue will result in net debt/equity reducing from of 3.6x as of FY26-end to 0.12x post-issue.

The company's status as the largest private packaged paneer brand in the organised market in India with 19 per cent market share (source: 1Lattice report), fast growth track record, improving margins and good headroom for capacity utilisation lends comfort. However, the aggressively-priced IPO narrows the margin of safety if things don't go as per plan. Hence, only investors with a high-risk appetite can consider the IPO.

The bullish argument rests on Milky Mist growing into its valuation. If underlying PAT grows around 40 per cent in FY27, from ₹127 crore to around ₹175-180 crore, and the proposed ₹496.86-crore loan repayment brings partial-year interest savings, PAT could reach around ₹190-195 crore on our estimates. That would pull the FY27 P/E down to roughly 55-57 times. In other words, strong execution is warranted to substantially close the valuation gap with Hatsun within a year.

BUSINESS

Milky Mist's origins are in paneer. It has since become a much broader value-added dairy and packaged-food company. Paneer remains the largest product, contributing 29.4 per cent of FY26 revenue. Cheese contributes 16.4 per cent and curd another 13.3 per cent. But newer categories are growing quickly. Ice-cream revenue rose from ₹35 crore in FY24 to ₹211 crore (6.7 per cent) in FY26, while yoghurt increased from ₹50 crore to ₹194 crore (6.2



per cent). Ghee accounts for 9.8 per cent and butter 6.1 per cent, among main categories.

Milky Mist controls much of its supply chain. According to the RHP, it procured milk from 74,654 farmers in FY26 and sourced 74.34 per cent directly from farmers. It operates one large manufacturing complex (Perundurai) and owns much of its cold-chain logistics. It had 4,001 distributors spread across 22 States and 5 Union Territories and over 3.75 lakh retail touchpoints, as of March 2026.

This integration is an advantage, but it also explains the heavy asset base. Milky Mist has invested aggressively in plants, automation, trucks and retail cooling equipment. The business, therefore, combines consumer-brand economics with the capital requirements of a dairy processor.

WHAT WE LIKE

The biggest opportunity remains paneer. The company-commissioned 1Lattice report estimates India's paneer market at about ₹1 lakh crore in FY26, while the organised paneer market was only around ₹4,850 crore. The latter is projected to reach about ₹12,180

Financial performance

	FY24	FY25	FY26
Revenue from operations (₹ cr)	1,821.6	2,349.5	3,138.4
Gross profit (₹ cr)	568.5	796.2	1,034.7
Gross profit margin (%)	31.2	33.9	33.0
EBITDA (₹ cr)	222.3	310.4	435.2
EBITDA margin (%)	12.2	13.2	13.9
PAT (₹ cr)	19.4	46.1	127.0
PAT margin (%)	1.1	2.0	4.1

Source: RHP

crore by FY31, a CAGR of around 20.2 per cent. Milky Mist already has about 19 per cent of the organised packaged-paneer market by value. The difference between the overall and organised market sizes shows the formalisation opportunity. Consumers shifting from loose paneer to packaged products do not require Milky Mist to win share from another organised brand.

Recent regulatory crackdowns have exposed adulterated and analogue paneer made with vegetable fats, starches and other non-milk ingredients being sold as genuine paneer, which could ac-

celerate the shift towards trusted branded packaged products. Parag Milk Foods, Doodla Dairy, Heritage Foods, Amul, Nandini, Aavin, Mother Dairy, Vijaya, and Milma etc. compete in organised curd and paneer markets. Britannia also actively competes in the paneer category.

There is also unused capacity. Paneer production was 24,920 tonnes in FY26 against available capacity of 47,520 tonnes, implying utilisation of just 52.4 per cent after a large capacity expansion. Ice-cream utilisation was only 29.4 per cent, while processed cheese was at 51.5 per cent and

IPO rating



yoghurt at 61.8 per cent. Higher utilisation can support growth without an equivalent increase in capacity every year.

Growth is also becoming broader. Five new product categories and 538 new SKUs launched between FY23 and FY26 contributed ₹884 crore, or 28.2 per cent of FY26 revenue.

Geographic expansion is another lever. South India's share of revenue has fallen from 73.7 per cent in FY24 to 69.2 per cent in FY26. Revenue from the rest of India grew at a 40.9 per cent CAGR over this period, faster than the company's overall growth.

The company has been operating cash-flow positive for the last three fiscals, with net cash from operating activities of ₹301 crore reported in FY26.

PRICE DEMANDS EXECUTION

Some valuation-conscious investors can argue the problem is that much of this opportunity is already reflected in the IPO price.

Milky Mist earned ₹435 crore of EBITDA and ₹127 crore of PAT in FY26. Despite the healthy 13.9 per cent EBITDA margin, the PAT margin was only 4.05 per cent. Finance cost of ₹106 crore and depreciation of ₹170 crore absorbed a large part of operating profit.

The IPO helps address this weakness. Of the ₹1,428-crore

fresh issue, ₹496.86 crore will repay borrowings. Another ₹469.24 crore will expand newer product lines, bolster some parts of existing capacities and modernise the Perundurai facility. About ₹155 crore will fund visco-coolers at retail shops and other retail cooling equipment.

Deleveraging should improve profit conversion. But investors should not count the entire benefit upfront. The exact repayment timing will determine FY27 interest savings. Our base case therefore assumes around 40 per cent underlying PAT growth and only a partial-year benefit from debt repayment.

On that basis, PAT of around ₹190-195 crore could bring the FY27 P/E to 55-57 times from the trailing 84.9 times. This would put the multiple around Hatsun's current P/E. But failure to maintain strong growth would leave little valuation cushion.

Price-to-book offers one counterpoint. On a post-issue book-value basis, Milky Mist works out to roughly 6 times at the upper band, against around 10.7 times for Hatsun based. But P/B alone cannot settle the valuation debate. Milky Mist's FY26 ROCE of 11.7 per cent remains modest for a stock seeking a premium consumer-company valuation.

There are other risks. Manufacturing is concentrated at one location. Nearly 70 per cent of revenue still comes from South India. The business remains capital-intensive, and expansion outside its home market will test the brand and cold-chain model.

So this is not an IPO to chase regardless of price. But for high-risk investors willing to bet on the company as a play on India's evolving consumption story linked to improving standards of living, better capacity utilisation and deleveraging, Milky Mist offers a runway to consider subscribing. The opportunity is attractive; the valuation leaves little room for execution errors.

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,571) and Nifty Bank (57,746) gained 0.8 per cent each last week, extending their recovery for a second consecutive week. However, the advance lacked strong conviction as the indices spent most of the week consolidating after the sharp rebound seen previously. The derivatives data suggests that while institutional participants continued to pare bearish bets, fresh bullish positioning remained limited.

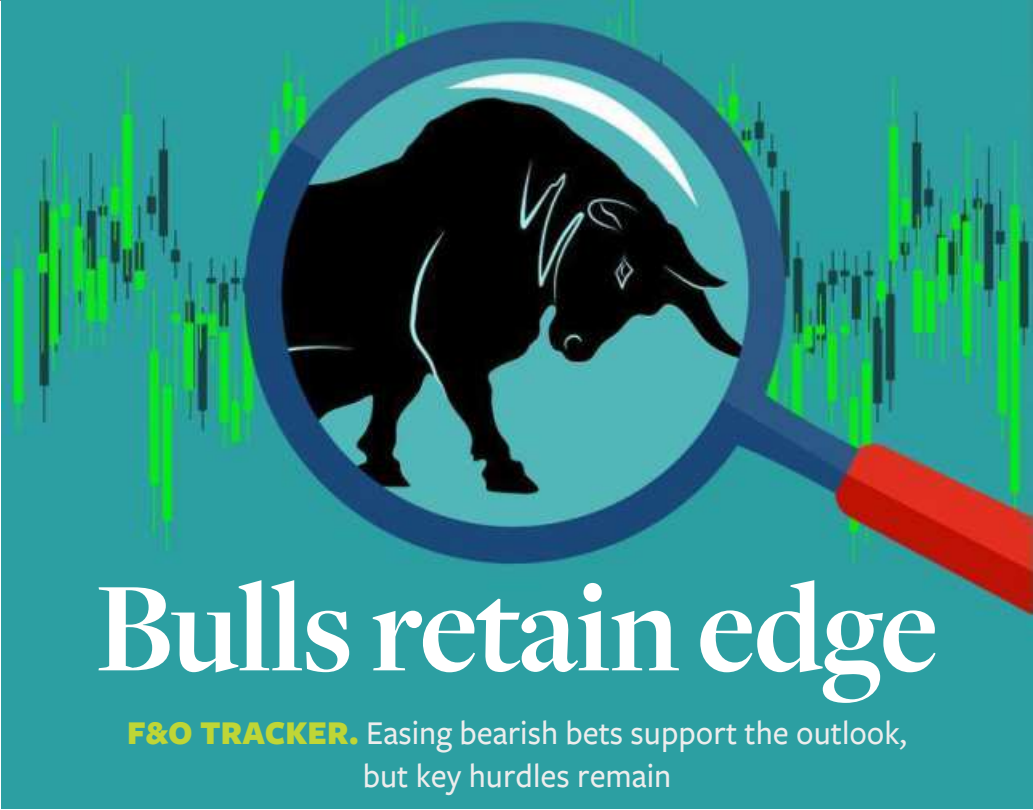
Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) turned less bearish. Their net short position in index futures narrowed 13 per cent to 1.50 lakh contracts. At the same time, net long positions in index puts declined 9 per cent to 4.14 lakh contracts, indicating a reduction in downside hedges. However, net short positions in index call options increased 15 per cent to 2.13 lakh contracts, suggesting that FIIs continued to write calls at higher levels, a sign of weakness.

But overall, the derivatives data indicates that bearish sentiment has eased.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Aug) (24,655) began last week on the front foot by opening with a gap-up. However, while it hit an intra-week high of 24,758 on Thursday, there was no strong follow-through rally through the week.

Nevertheless, the August futures posted a weekly gain of 0.8 per cent. As this happened, the outstanding open interest of this contract dropped 5 per cent to 120.5 lakh contracts, implying short covering in futures.

With respect to options, the PCR (Put Call Ratio) of weekly expiry stood at 0.7 whereas that of August monthly contracts was



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at 1.1 on Friday, suggesting that the option traders broadly hold a positive view.

Therefore, futures and options data show a positive bias. However, the chart shows that for the bulls to strengthen their hand, the breakout of 24,750 is necessary.

If the resistance at 24,750 is breached, Nifty futures can rally to 25,000 and 25,250. Instead, if the contract falls from the current level of 24,655, it can decline to 24,500, a support. Next support is at 24,400.

Strategy: Last week, we suggested buying Nifty futures on a breakout of 24,600. Retain this trade and maintain stop-loss at 24,400.

When the contract rises to 24,800 and 24,900, tighten the stop-loss to 24,680 and 24,800, respectively. Exit at 25,000.

DERIVATIVE OUTLOOK

- FII futures shorts moderate
- Nifty futures eyes 24,750 breakout
- Nifty Bank futures holds above 58,000

NIFTY BANK

Nifty Bank futures (Aug) (58,020), after opening last week with a gap-up, was charting a sideways trend through the week. It was oscillating between 57,600 and 58,200.

The weekly gain stood at 1 per cent and the open interest of August futures decreased by a marginal 2 per cent to 20.8 lakh contracts. A weekly gain accompanied by a drop in open

interest denotes short covering.

The PCR of August options increased from 0.85 to 0.90. Although marginal, it shows that call writing was greater recently.

Overall, derivatives data shows a bullish inclination.

Chart shows that the August futures saw a daily close above 58,000 on both Thursday and Friday, a positive signal. So, there is a good chance for Nifty Bank futures to gain more traction in the coming sessions, possibly leading to a rally to 60,000.

If the contract falls it can find support at 57,600 and 57,000.

Strategy: Last week, we suggested buying Nifty Bank futures (Aug) on a breakout of 58,000. Hold on with stop-loss at 57,000.

When the contract rallies to 59,000 and 59,500, raise the stop-loss to 58,250 and 59,000 respectively. Exit at 60,000.

Choosing option strikes

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Demand for a strike can matter more than time left for expiry

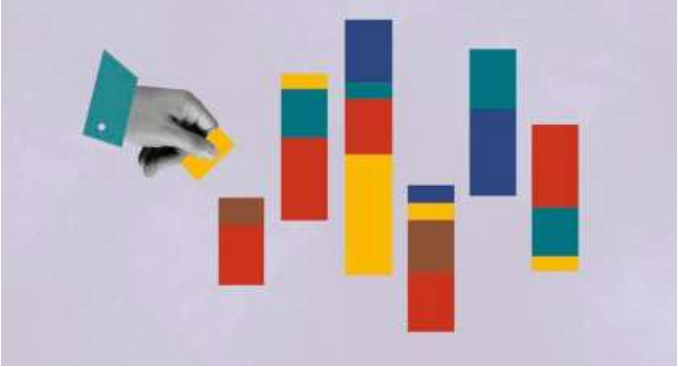
Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Previously in this column, we discussed why option strikes should be chosen based on their implied volatility. This week, we revisit this argument as a follow-up to a query from an options trader: Why not choose strikes based on time value instead of implied volatility?

DEMAND FACTOR

Option is a wasting asset, as its value declines with each passing day. This loss in value is captured through the time-value component of the option price. So, the lower the amount you pay for the time value, the better. Time value of an option consists of two factors – time to expiry and implied volatility. You will most likely shortlist strikes of the same expiry when you want to initiate a long call or put position. If the time-to-expiry component is the same for all the strikes, the remaining part of the time-value component must be implied volatility.

So, it appears that choosing an option strike based on time value ought to be the same as choosing one based on implied volatility. To explain, suppose the time to



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● RIGHT CHOICE

Whether you isolate implied volatility from time value or not, the choice of strike must remain the same

expiry component of an option price is, say, six points. Then, it must be six points for all the strikes with the same expiry. So, whether you isolate implied volatility from time value or not, the choice of strike must remain the same, so the argument goes.

IMPLIED VOLATILITY

The issue is that an option's time

value is a function of the location of the strike from the current price of its underlying. That is, higher (lower) a call (put) strike, lower the absolute time value of an option. This is because such strikes are less sensitive to changes in the underlying price as the ones closer to the current underlying price. While the time value of such strike may be lower, their implied volatility could be higher. This is because demand for a strike affects its implied volatility.

You can verify this argument by applying real-time option data into a Black-Scholes-Merton (BSM) model-based option calculator available on the Internet.

You need to input the current price of an underlying (say, Nifty Index), strike price, risk-free rate, time to expiry and option price. The output will be each strike's implied volatility.

After you get the initial implied volatility, change the option price by five or 10 points and see how the implied volatility changes. Of course, change in the underlying price will also drive time value. The point is that the change in option price can be greater than the change in the underlying price because of a sharp increase in demand for a particular strike, pushing up implied volatility.

OPTIONAL READING

It is optimal to choose a strike with the lowest implied volatility among the three strikes immediately above (below) an underlying price for calls (puts). This will ensure the option has enough room to capture delta gains after adjusting for loss from time decay (theta). Alternatively, you could choose the immediate OTM strike.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal interests

Outlook positive

BULLION CUES. Traders can buy the dips

Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau

Precious metals witnessed a considerable rally last week. Gold (\$4,342/ounce) and silver (\$63.90/ounce) surged 7.3 per cent and 10.3 per cent, respectively. Similarly, in the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,51,820/10 gm) was up 5.9 per cent and silver futures (₹2,31,466/kg) gained 6.6 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,51,820)

Gold futures (Oct), which saw a muted opening last Monday, gained traction and saw a sharp rally in the following sessions. It broke out of a resistance at ₹1,47,000 and also, the price is now above both 21- and 50-day moving averages.

The short-term outlook appears positive for gold futures. On the upside, it could rise to ₹1,58,000. But before this uptick, the contract might see a minor correction in price, potentially to ₹1,49,000.

If gold futures breaches the resistance-turned-support at ₹1,47,000, it can extend the downswing to ₹1,43,000.



Trade strategy: Buy on a dip to ₹1,49,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,58,000 and ₹1,46,000, respectively.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,31,466)

Silver futures (Sep) rebounded on the back of the support at ₹2,14,000 and surpassed a hurdle at ₹2,27,000 last week.

While the price action shows a positive bias, the contract has a barrier ahead at ₹2,38,000. A breakout of this will clear the way for a sustainable rally to ₹2,59,000.

In case the contract falls from the current level, it can find support at ₹2,27,000 and ₹2,20,000.

Trade strategy: Go long if the price dips to ₹2,27,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,50,000 and ₹2,19,000 respectively.

Uncertainty remains

CRUDE CHECK. Hold shorts with strict stop-loss

Akhil Nallamuthu

Oil extended the decline last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$83.60/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹7,424/barrel) lost 5 per cent and 8.5 per cent, respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$83.60)

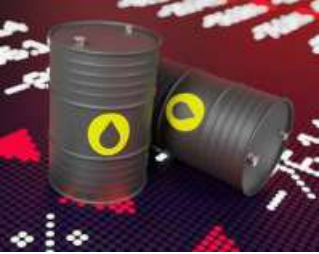
Brent crude futures began last week with a gap-down open. It slipped to mark a low of \$78.11 on Wednesday before recovering to \$83.60.

Although the contract has been on a decline in the past two weeks, the outlook now appears unclear. A further decline from the current level can drag the contract back to \$78. A breach of this can open the door for a decline to \$71.

On the other hand, if the contract recovers and rises above \$86, it can strengthen to \$91. Only a clear breakout of \$91 will turn the trend positive again.

MCX CRUDE OIL (₹7,424)

Crude oil futures (Aug) opened with a gap-down last Monday. It then slipped below the support at



₹7,500 to a low of ₹7,078 on Wednesday.

While there was a recovery towards the end of last week, the contract failed to reclaim ₹7,500-mark. Until this resistance is valid, the bias will remain bearish where the price can drop to ₹6,500.

However, if the contract surpasses ₹7,500, it will face a resistance at ₹8,200. A clear breakout of this level can turn the near-term outlook positive and lift the contract to ₹10,000.

But now there is uncertainty about the path of the next move.

Trade strategy: Traders can retain the short that we suggested last week once ₹7,500 is breached. Target and stop-loss can be ₹6,500 and ₹8,050, respectively.

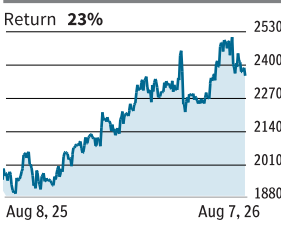
F&O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU,
bl. research bureau

I hold a short position on Lupin August futures. Selling price is ₹2,400. What is the outlook for the stock? Is it advisable to hold this trade?

Vaibhav Desai



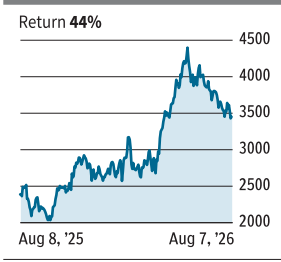
Lupin (₹2,363.50): The stock of Lupin has seen a decline in price recently. However, from the current level, there is a support immediately at ₹2,350. Just below this is a trendline support at ₹2,330. These levels have the potential to arrest

further decline, especially considering that the long-term is bullish. So, the likelihood of immediate rebound and a rally to ₹2,460 and ₹2,500 is highly likely. That said, in case the stock breaches the support at ₹2,330, the sell-off can intensify, potentially dragging the stock down to ₹2,250.

With respect to August futures, which closed at ₹2,380 on Friday, has support at ₹2,370 and ₹2,340. A recovery from the current level can lift the contract to ₹2,475 whereas a breach of ₹2,340 can trigger a decline to ₹2,260. Given the above factors, we suggest exiting your short position at the current level. Fresh shorts can be initiated in case the futures decisively breach the support at ₹2,340.

I have a long position on BSE August futures bought for ₹3,602. Should I exit or hold?

Palani Shanmugam



BSE (₹3,457.10): The stock has been in a downtrend for over two months now. The price has consistently been below the 21-day moving average, showing a bearish bias.

As it stands, there are neither indications of a bullish trend reversal nor a support nearby that can

arrest the fall. Notable immediate support can be spotted at ₹3,200 followed by ₹3,000.

Given the current scenario, the probability for the stock to decline to ₹3,200-3,000 price band is high. Any rise in price meanwhile is likely to be short-lived.

Similarly, the August futures, now trading at ₹3,473.40, will also most likely see another leg of fall, possibly to ₹3,200 before any considerable recovery is seen. Thus, we suggest exiting the trade now.

● Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Aug 7	Weekly change %	As on Aug 7	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	26129	6	189917	0
Future Index Short	176187	-11	59531	-4
Net Futures	-150058	-13	130386	2
Index Call options Long	586358	30	3056750	19
Index Call options Short	799389	26	3091110	22
Net Call options	-213031	15	-34360	-242
Index Put options Long	840884	-7	2446522	-17
Index Put options Short	426472	-6	3013273	-17
Net Put Options	414412	-9	-566751	-18

FIIs have reduced net short on index futures. But they have increased net short on index calls and cut net long on index puts. No clear bias seen.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Aug 7)				
LICI	394.00	-7.2	1115.3	183.5
BLUESTARCO	1,514.00	-9.9	107.3	177.4
BSE	3,457.10	-5.2	305.9	84.3
UPL	573.00	-5.2	681.3	73.8
BOSCHLTD	42,950.00	4.5	5.9	69.8
FALL (as on Aug 7)				
KPITTECH	629.90	5.3	381.2	-14.6
HYUNDAI	2,200.50	0.9	81.5	-9.1
EICHERMOT	8,020.00	2.4	76.0	-7.9
TATAELXI	3,781.00	2.9	45.9	-6.3
LT	4,056.00	3.0	228.1	-4.4

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Aug 10)

BANDHANBNK	KAYNES	LICI
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
Weekly change (%)				
COMMODITIES (as on Aug 7)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Aug	350.6 (2.7)	5,329 (37)	Long build-up
COPPER	31-Aug	1,365.5 (1.8)	10,410 (-10)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	19-Aug	7,424.0 (-8.5)	8,899 (3)	Short build-up
CRUDEOILM	19-Aug	7,427.0 (-8.5)	26,283 (-1)	Long unwinding
GOLD	5-Oct	1,51,820.0 (5.9)	10,436 (12)	Long build-up
GOLDGUINEA	31-Aug	1,20,896.0 (5.3)	14,242 (-20)	Short covering
GOLDM	4-Sep	1,50,471.0 (5.5)	31,603 (0)	Long build-up
GOLDPETAL	31-Aug	15,118.0 (5.3)	1,87,158 (-9)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	31-Aug	1,50,539.0 (5.4)	23,334 (-25)	Short covering
LEAD	31-Aug	197.4 (0.3)	702 (32)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	26-Aug	255.6 (-2.7)	60,889 (14)	Short build-up
SILVER	4-Sep	2,31,466.0 (6.6)	11,177 (-14)	Short covering
SILVERM	31-Aug	2,32,709.0 (5.8)	28,108 (-10)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	31-Aug	2,32,673.0 (5.8)	81,567 (-25)	Short covering
ZINC	31-Aug	389.1 (1.4)	2,752 (7)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Aug 7)				
USDINR	27-Aug	95.25 (-0.4)	16,54,322 (46)	Short build-up
EURINR	27-Aug	110.09 (0.1)	4,677 (-3)	Short covering
GBPINR	27-Aug	128.70 (-0.1)	26,532 (122)	Short build-up
JPYINR	27-Aug	60.26 (0.9)	382 (360)	Long build-up

F&O Strategy

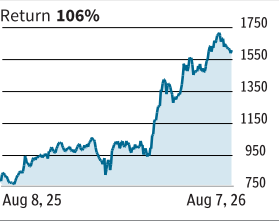
Bull call spread on Adani Energy Solutions

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook for the stock of Adani Energy Solutions (₹1,630.10) remains positive. Immediate support levels are at ₹1,570 and ₹1,435. A close below the latter will change the medium term outlook to negative.

The stock finds an immediate resistance at ₹1,683. A close above this will reignite fresh rally in the stock.

F&O pointers: The August futures of Adani Energy Solutions closed at ₹1,628.30, which is at a dis-



count to the spot price of ₹1,630.10.

The contract witnessed unwinding of long positions in the last 10 days as the stock fell from ₹1,710 to ₹1,625. Option trading indicates that it could move between ₹1,600 and ₹1,700.

Strategy: Consider bull-call spread on the stock by buying 1640-call and simultaneously selling 1660-call. As these options closed with premiums of ₹40.90 and ₹32.70 respectively, the net cost for this strategy would be ₹8.20/lot or ₹5,535.

The maximum loss would be the premium paid, i.e., ₹5,535, and that will happen if the stock remains below ₹1,640 on expiry. However, a profit of ₹7,965 is possible, if the stock closes above ₹1,660.

Follow-up: We advised going long on NTPC. But the stock slipped. However, we advise traders to hold the position with a stop loss at ₹341.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

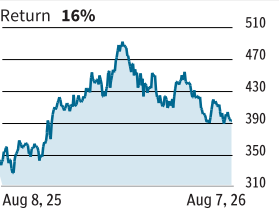
Indus Towers F&O adjustments

Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau

On August 4, Indus Towers (₹386) announced an interim dividend of ₹14. The face value per equity share is ₹10. The dividend will lead to necessary adjustments in the futures and options (F&O) contracts on this stock on the record date.

The company has decided August 10 as the record/effective date. On this day, the stock price and all derivatives contracts on Indus Towers will be adjusted appropriately.



With respect to adjustment in futures contracts, the reference rate of the relevant contract on August 7 will be considered. Reference rate will be the mark-to-market settlement price of the relevant futures contract. So, the open positions shall be carried forward to August 10 at the daily settlement price on August 7 minus ₹14, the dividend amount.

Since August expiry futures closed at ₹387 on Friday (August 7), it will be revised to ₹373 (₹387 minus ₹14) on Monday (August 10). Hence, the contract value will come down.

Likewise, in options, all the strike prices in the option chain of Indus Towers will be subtracted by ₹14 from August 10. For example, the strike price of 390 and 395 will be modified to 376 and 381 respectively on Monday.

That said, the above measures are not likely to impact the overall trend of this stock.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index opened the week with a wide gap-up last week. But thereafter, they stayed in a narrow range all through the week. The benchmark indices were up in the range of 0.5-0.85 per cent. On the charts, the bias is positive. Supports are there to limit the downside. We expect the indices to sustain above their support and go higher in the coming weeks.

FPIS BUY
The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) bought the Indian equities for the third consecutive week. Indeed, the quantum of their purchase was also much higher compared to the previous two weeks. The equity segment saw a net inflow of about \$1.35 billion. Following the inflow of \$2.12 billion in July, the month of August has begun on a positive note. We will have to wait and see if the FPIs accelerate their purchase. That in turn can aid the benchmark indices to go higher.

NIFTY (24,570.65)
Short-term view: The outlook is positive. Supports are at 24,500 and 24,400. Nifty can rise to 24,750 or 24,850 from there. Failure to breach 24,850 can drag it down to 24,600-24,500 again. But a decisive break above 24,850 can boost the momentum. It will then clear the way for a rise to 25,200-25,400.
The near-term picture will turn negative only if the Nifty declines below 24,400. If that happens, a fall to 24,200 or 24,000 can be seen.

The level of 23,850 is a crucial support. The short-term outlook will turn bearish only on a break below this support. But that looks less likely.

Medium-term outlook: Nifty is inching up within its broad 22,000-26,500 range. As mentioned last week, a decisive break above 24,850 will strengthen the case for seeing 26,500, the upper end of the range. We expect the Nifty to make a bullish breakout above 26,500 eventually. Such a break can trigger a fresh rally to 28,000 and even 30,000 in the long term. Nifty has to decline below 22,000 to turn the big picture negative.

NIFTY BANK (57,746.45)
Short-term view: The price action last week indicates that the index is getting good sup-



port in the 57,500-57,350 region. The near-term picture is positive to see a rise to 58,500, an immediate resistance. A break above this hurdle can take it further higher to 59,000 and even 60,000 in the short term.

The near-term picture will turn negative if the index declines below 57,350. If that happens, a fall to 56,600 is possible.

Medium-term view: The broader picture remains bullish. The rise above 59,000 mentioned above can strengthen the momentum. It will then clear the way for the Nifty Bank index to see 65,000 on the upside in the medium term. The index has potential to target 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

Series of supports are there at 55,000, 53,000 and 50,000. Nifty

Bank index has to fall below 50,000 to negate our long-term bullish view. But that looks unlikely.

SENSEX (78,499.17)
Short-term view: The index oscillated around 78,500 all through the week. Support is at 77,500 and resistance is at 79,500. We expect the index to sustain above 77,500 and go up to 79,500 or 80,000 in the near term. An eventual break above 80,000 can then take the Sensex higher to 81,000-82,000 in the short term.

A break below 77,500 will turn the near-term outlook negative. It will then drag the index down to 77,000 or even 76,000.

Medium-term view: The broader 71,000-86,000 range is

SUPPORT TO WATCH

- Nifty 50: 24,400
- Sensex: 77,500
- Nifty Bank: 57,350

intact. Within that we expect the Sensex to move higher towards 86,000, the upper end of the range in the medium term. A break above 81,000 can trigger this rise.

From a long-term perspective, Sensex is expected to breach 86,000 eventually. Such a break can take it higher to 90,000 and even 94,000.

Sensex has to decline below 71,000 to negate this long-term bullish view.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (23,362.90)
The crucial 23,300-23,500 resistance zone is holding well for now. Immediate support is around 23,200. If the index manages to sustain above this support, then the chances are high to see a breakout above 23,500 from here. Such a break will trigger the much-awaited rally to 26,000-26,500 in the medium term. It will also keep the upside open to see 28,000-28,500 over the long term.

If the index declines below 23,200 from here, then 23,050-23,000 can be seen on the downside initially. Failure to bounce back from around 23,000 can

then drag the Nifty Midcap 150 index down to 22,800 and even lower.

Such a fall will not negate our broader bullish view. It will only delay the rally to 26,500 and 28,500.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,356.55)
The index has risen and closed just above the crucial resistance level of 18,300. It is now very important for it get a strong follow-through rise from here. If that happens, then a fresh rally to 22,500-23,000 can be seen from here. That in turn will clear the way for the Nifty Smallcap 250 index to touch 24,000-25,000 in the long term.

Failure to get a strong follow-through rise and a fall below 18,000 can turn the short-term picture negative. It can then trigger a fall to 17,500-17,400 can be seen. In that case, the expected rally will get delayed.

bl.portfolio video

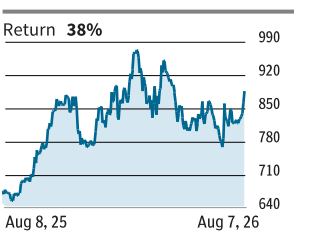
Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English Tamil

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

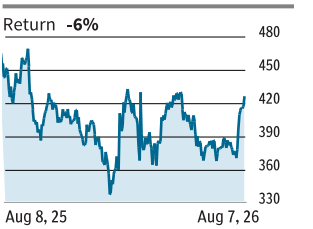
Indian Bank (₹899)
Confirms a reversal pattern



The stock of Indian Bank rallied a little over 7 per cent last week. This has led to the breakout of a notable resistance at ₹880 last week. The breach of ₹880 has confirmed an inverted head and shoulder pattern, indicating a bullish trend reversal. That said, before the next uptick, we might see some correction,

possibly to ₹870 or ₹850. A rally after that can lift the stock to ₹1,000. So, traders can buy now at ₹899 and accumulate at ₹860. Place initial stop-loss at ₹825. When the stock moves up to ₹950, raise the stop-loss to ₹910. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹950 when the price hits ₹970. Book profits at ₹990.

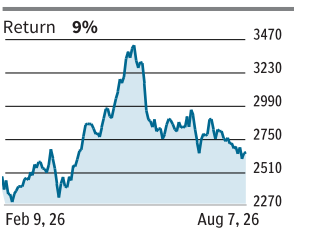
LT Foods (₹428.30)
Builds positive momentum



The stock of LT Foods has appreciated for two weeks in a row, indicating a considerable positive momentum. This rally began on the back of a support at ₹370. Going ahead, there might be some correction in price as the stock is now hovering near the resistance at ₹440. But this downtick is likely

to be temporary. We expect the stock to eventually rise above ₹440 and move to ₹600 before the end of this year. Therefore, traders can go long now at ₹428 and buy more shares if the price slips to ₹400. Initial stop-loss can be ₹350. When the stock touches ₹500 and ₹550, tighten the stop-loss to ₹470 and ₹530 respectively. Book profits at ₹600.

MCX (₹2,650)
Strong supports ahead



The stock of MCX (Multi Commodity Exchange) has shed nearly 24 per cent since it hit an all-time high of ₹3,479.80 in May. While it is now trading at ₹2,650, there are key support levels at ₹2,550 and ₹2,450. A decline below these levels is less likely. We expect the stock to recover either from the current

level or after a decline to ₹2,550-2,450 price band. Once the rally resumes, the stock can appreciate to ₹3,400. Participants can buy now at ₹2,650 and add more shares if the price drops to ₹2,550. Place stop-loss at ₹2,350 first. When the stock rises to ₹3,100 and ₹3,300, revise the stop-loss to ₹2,800 and ₹3,200 respectively. Exit at ₹3,400.

Momentum returns

US MARKET OUTLOOK. The broader uptrend is still alive

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices witnessed a strong rise last week. The Dow Jones and the S&P 500 were up 2.95 per cent and 3.58 per cent, respectively. The NASDAQ Composite index on the other hand surged over 5 per cent. The significant rise last week indicates that the broader uptrend is still alive. It has also opened the doors for more upside from here.

DOW JONES (54,042.39)
The break above 53,100 and the rise to 54,400 has happened. Indeed, the index surged to a high of 54,749.47 and has come down from there. The rise last week marks the end of the corrective fall that was in place since early July.

The region between 53,200 and 53,000 will now be a very good support. Resistance is around 54,650. As long as the index stays above 53,000, the bias is bullish to see a break above 54,650. Such a break can take the Dow Jones higher to 56,000 initially.

From a medium-term perspective, the Dow Jones now has the potential to target 58,000 on the upside. A decisive break below 53,000 is needed to negate the bullish view and drag it down to 50,000.

S&P 500 (7,757.63)
The three-month long sideways consolidation has ended, and the S&P 500 index has made a bullish breakout. The region between 7,600 and 7,550 will now be a very good support. An immediate fall below this support zone is unlikely.

The outlook is bullish. The S&P 500 index can now rise to 8,000 in the coming weeks. The price action thereafter will need a very close watch. Failure to breach 8,000 can drag the S&P



RANGE BOUND
The US 10Yr Treasury Yield is stuck between 4.6 per cent and 4.75 per cent for more than two weeks now

500 index down to 7,600-7,500 again. But if it manages to break above 8,000, then there are good chances to see an extended rise to 8,400-8,450.

From a big picture, cluster of supports are there in the 7,400-7,200 region. The index has to decline below 7,200 to turn the outlook bearish.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,690.62)

Contrary to our expectation, the NASDAQ Composite index has risen breaking above the key resistance level of 26,000. This marks the end of the downtrend that was in place since June. It has also negated the chances of the fall to 23,900 that we had mentioned last week. Support is now in the 26,000-25,500 region.

However, there is not much room left on the upside from here. The index can test 27,000 in the near term. A break above it can take it further higher to 28,000, an important resistance. The chances of a rise beyond 28,000 is less likely. As such we

can expect the upside to be capped at 28,000 for the NASDAQ Composite. The index can turn down again from around 28,000. So, we prefer to remain cautious rather than becoming overly bullish on the NASDAQ Composite index again.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK
The dollar index (99.60) remained lower but was stable all through last week. The index was stuck between 99.40 and 100. Key support is in the 99.20-99 region which can limit downside for now. However, a sustained rise above 100 is needed to get some relief and go back up to 100.50-101 again.

Failure to rise past 100 can keep the dollar index vulnerable to break 99 and fall to 98 in the short term. It is a wait-and-watch situation for now.

TREASURY YIELD
The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.65 per cent) is stuck between 4.6 per cent and 4.75 per cent for more than two weeks now. The bias is positive to see a rise to 4.8 per cent initially. From a big picture, the US 10Yr Treasury Yield has the potential to breach 4.8 per cent and rise to 5 per cent in the coming months.

In case the yield declines below 4.6 per cent, the next support in the 4.5-4.45 per cent region can limit the downside.

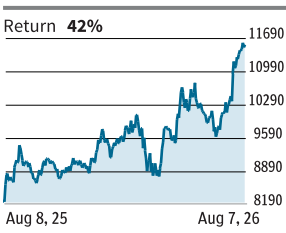
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

I have bought Bajaj Auto shares at ₹9,150. What is the outlook?

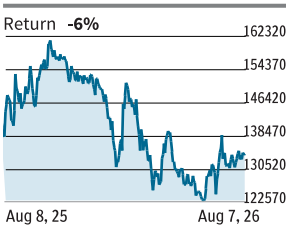
Sachin



Bajaj Auto (₹11,642): The outlook is bullish. The strong surge breaking above the key resistance level of ₹10,800 indicates that the stock has gained momentum. The region between ₹10,800 and ₹10,750 will now be a

very good support. Keep a stop-loss at ₹10,520 and hold the stock. Bajaj Auto share price has potential to target ₹14,600 over the next one year. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹11,150 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹12,400. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹12,200 and ₹13,400 when the price touches ₹12,900 and ₹13,900, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹14,500. This bullish view will come under threat only if the price declines below ₹10,750. If that happens, a fall to ₹9,800 can be seen. But that looks less likely.

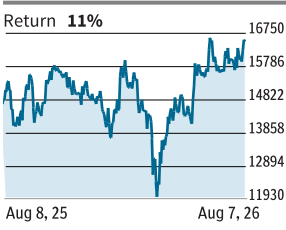
Is this a good time to buy MRF shares?
Er. Harminder Singh Gumbhir



MRF (₹13,417): The long-term outlook is bullish for MRF. The recent bounce from the low of ₹1,22,000 made in May is happening from the 200-Week Moving Average (WMA). History shows that the stock has seen a strong rally every

time it had bounced from this 200-WMA. The upside is now open to see ₹1,88,000 in the next 12 to 18 months. You can buy MRF shares now at ₹1,34,179. Accumulate on dips at ₹1,25,800. Keep the stop-loss at ₹1,14,200. Trial the stop-loss up to ₹1,40,800 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,46,200. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,46,500, ₹1,59,800 and ₹1,68,900 as soon as the stock price goes up to ₹1,54,600, ₹1,64,400 and ₹1,74,800 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,85,800.

I am holding shares of LMW at an average price of ₹6,008. Should I continue to hold or exit?
V.Subbarao, Mumbai

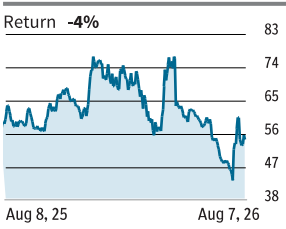


LMW (₹16,619): The long-term trend is up and is very much intact. The price action since September 2024 indicates a bull flag formation in the monthly chart. A sustained rise above ₹17,000 will confirm the same. It will

also indicate that the broader uptrend has resumed. That leg of upmove will have the potential to take LMW share price higher to ₹22,000-₹23,000 over the next one year. Strong support is around ₹15,500 which can limit the downside for now. Keep a stop-loss at ₹14,200 and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹17,200 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹18,500. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹18,800 and ₹20,400 when the share price touches ₹19,700 and ₹21,200, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹21,900.

I am planning to buy Asian Granito India shares. Please advise

Vishal Shah, Mumbai



Asian Granito India (₹54.75): The stock has been oscillating in a very wide range of ₹37 and ₹104 for more than four years now. Within that, the price is now bouncing back after making a low of ₹42.50 in July. If this bounce sustains, there

are good chances for the price to rise towards ₹80 initially. An extended rise to ₹92 is also a possibility that cannot be ruled out. But you need to have a lot of patience if you intend to enter this stock. If that suits you, then buy now and accumulate at ₹47. Keep the stop-loss at ₹39. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹59 when the price goes up to ₹66. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹63 and ₹69 when the price touches ₹68 and ₹73 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹78.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

BANDU'S PICKS

- 1 Devyani International**
- 2 Aditya Infotech**
- 3 NALCO**
- 4 Grasim Industries**
- 5 Indian Bank**

Last week's prize winner
Ajitha Kumar

Last week's winning stock
Ramkrishna Forgings

Closing price (July 31)
₹650.85

Closing price (Aug 7)
₹726.05

Return
11.55 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Take500

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 0.5 and 0.8 per cent respectively last week. BSE Metal gained the most by 3 per cent, followed by BSE Capital Goods 2.9 per cent and BSE Auto 2.9 per cent. BSE Realty and BSE Oil & Gas declined by 1.7 and 0.5 per cent respectively last week.		Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare
	P/E	20.9	20.9	37.5	14.1	53.4	66.6	33.9	45.2
	P/BV	3.0	4.2	7.8	2.4	15.4	17.8	7.7	7.9
	Dividend Yield	1.3	1.2	1.0	0.8	0.5	0.5	0.9	0.5
	Weekly Return (%)	0.8 ▲	0.5 ▲	2.9 ▲	0.9 ▲	2.9 ▲	-0.3 ▼	0.9 ▲	0.9 ▲
	Monthly Return (%)	0.7 ▲	0.4 ▲	7.8 ▲	-0.5 ▼	1.3 ▲	5.1 ▲	-1.2 ▼	3.0 ▲
	Annual Return (%)	-0.1 ▼	-2.6 ▼	22.3 ▲	6.0 ▲	16.9 ▲	8.2 ▲	-9.2 ▼	17.4 ▲

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Y-High	Y-Low
360 ONE [1]	1166.1	31.0	37.6	4.8	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	2.7	14.3	0.0	1235.7	906.2
3M India [1]	3599.8	542.7	66.3	18.9	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	4.3	39.8	0.0	3830.0	2874.7
A B B [2]	7600.0	72.7	104.5	17.2	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	-13.0	-4.3	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [1]	93.8	17	5.36	8.1	202606	11.1	20.6	9.1	31.5	-0.8	12.5	0.2	151.7	87.7
A B Real Estate [1]	1382.0	-27.0	4.2	202603	-79.1	-878.4	-66.4	-605.4	-2.8	-4.1	1.4	1.9745	1080.1	
Adani Energy Sol. [1]	1628.0	23.9	68.2	3.0	202606	42.4	124.2	19.0	21.5	2.2	11.1	0.5	1789.0	745.5
Aarti Industries [5]	501.9	14.4	34.9	2.1	202606	49.5	256.6	27.0	122.2	2.5	6.2	0.7	527.9	338.2
Abbott Financials [1]	1370.0	61.9	22.1	2.9	202403	21.4	25.3	25.4	14.2	0.0	43.8	0.0	3403.5	2516.0
AAVAS India [1]	2780.4	730.4	38.0	12.4	202603	6.5	7.6	8.1	9.7	0.0	49.9	0.0	3777.0	1050.4
ACC [1]	1363.7	101.2	13.5	1.3	202606	-4.6	-56.3	11.5	-18.6	0.4	0.12	0.0	1986.9	1250.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	368.1	8.4	43.7	3.3	202606	67.8	64.8	47.5	45.4	1.5	7.4	2.8	398.5	195.7
Action Const.Eq. [2]	1095.3	36.7	29.4	6.5	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	33.1	2.4	40.2	0.0	1169.9	164.1
Acuteas Chemical [5]	3296.2	47.2	69.3	16.3	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	104.3	6.3	20.1	0.1	3735.0	1264.0
Adani Enterprises [1]	3007.0	150	158.1	4.3	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	-28.8	0.0	5.6	1.5	3245.0	175.3
Adani Green [1]	1517.2	11.5	114.7	11.7	202606	15.6	16.7	17.2	19.0	-0.9	0.0	0.7	174.4	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1686.0	57.7	29.2	4.1	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.8	-0.8	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1291.0
Adani Power [2]	208.3	7.4	28.2	6.5	202606	34.0	42.0	6.6	14.9	-1.4	16.6	0.8	254.2	110.5
Adani Total Gas [1]	656.8	5.7	114.3	14.9	202606	27.2	14.2	19.8	-2.4	0.8	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	1025.4	34.9	29.4	7.4	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	3.9	1.2	0.0	0.0	1224.7	70.8
Aditya Birla Fas. [1]	63.3	-6.1	1.3	202606	10.6	-20.15	11.4	-1.4	5.1	0.0	0.9	0.9	95.0	53.6
Aditya Birla Cap.	414.5	14.7	28.2	3.0	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	2.5	8.8	4.9	430.6	267.0
Aditya Infotech [1]	3706.1	31.2	118.7	23.3	202603	45.5	207.7	35.6	160.5	9.3	28.1	0.3	3865.0	1041.9
Aegis Logistics [1]	1737.3	35.6	38.5	8.0	202606	37.1	268.9	36.4	88.7	7.2	16.1	0.8	1499.0	145.0
Aegis Vopak Term [1]	285.3	2.4	116.7	9.3	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	-1.8	8.7	1.9	31.5	155.8
Aether Industri. [1]	1590.6	18.1	88.0	8.6	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	30.4	2.8	9.7	0.1	1618.0	723.2
Afcons Infotech [1]	273.2	5.6	49.0	1.8	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-61.5	-0.7	10.5	0.6	479.1	265.4
Air India [2]	434.0	32.3	50.9	1.3	202603	20.0	19.5	19.1	19.5	1.6	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.2
AIA Engineering [2]	474.6	136.4	3.4	5.5	202603	9.6	37.9	0.1	19.9	3.6	19.1	0.1	5175.0	300.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3488.0	90.8	38.4	9.6	202606	14.8	30.9	20.2	22.0	0.5	31.8	0.0	3598.4	2335.0
Alkem Lab [2]	5630.6	201.8	27.9	4.9	202603	14.6	3.6	13.5	11.4	-2.1	19.7	0.1	93.1	5563.0
Alkerm Blenders [2]	598.0	8.4	75.0	1.1	202606	6.1	-12.0	8.0	-17.1	-3.6	18.3	0.0	120.0	38.2
Alko Industries [1]	12.0	-1.5	75.0	10.1	202606	6.5	-178.9	8.9	18.6	0.4	0.0	0.0	19.3	11.1
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	932.2	38.5	24.2	2.1	202603	15.5	11.6	7.5	-18.9	-2.4	11.7	0.0	105.0	67.5
Amber Enterp. [1]	745.0	57.1	12.9	6.0	202603	10.5	-26.8	12.2	-0.7	-0.3	13.5	0.8	897.0	540.0
Amruba Cements [2]	197.5	2.2	92.2	1.8	202606	-7.7	-29.1	-1.7	5.7	0.4	6.7	0.0	63.1	394.0
Anand Rathi Wea. [1]	2099.7	49.2	42.6	17.5	202606	17.5	22.7	22.7	45.3	0.0	19.0	0.0	2249.4	1269.5
Anant Raj [2]	61.6	15.4	4.0	3.8	202606	19.6	23.6	21.9	30.4	-1.3	12.0	0.1	744.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	29.2	11.3	2.59	4.4	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	-2.0	14.8	1.0	360.2	208.9
Anthem Bioscienc [2]	840.8	17.8	79.8	15.6	202606	-22.6	-11.7	-11.0	57.6	-0.7	17.4	0.0	100.0	13.4
API [1]	16597.7	300.0	55.3	12.2	202606	27.2	27.2	24.0	37.7	15.6	36.2	3.6	11714.0	6800.0
APOLLO Tubes [2]	1964.0	44.3	44.0	10.3	202606	8.7	10.9	10.6	13.0	0.8	22.0	0.2	230.9	154.0
Apollo Hospitals [1]	8990.5	136.0	66.0	13.6	202603	18.1	35.9	15.8	35.3	0.3	18.1	0.7	9326.8	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	445.4	33.6	13.3	1.7	202606	12.8	0.1	11.2	72.5	3.9	13.4	0.3	543.0	345.4
Apurva Health. [2]	173.3	8.4	20.9	1.1	202606	18.2	34.9	-0.2	34.1	-0.2	19.0	0.0	120.0	13.4
Asahi India Glas [1]	899.2	17.5	51.3	5.8	202606	14.2	165.4	9.3	37.0	2.8	13.1	0.9	1073.0	775.1
Ashok Leyland [1]	177.1	6.4	27.9	7.3	202603	17.1	9.0	15.9	20.9	0.6	13.8	4.3	215.4	110.0
Asian Paints [1]	2721.0	50.9	53.5	12.2	202606	17.9	40.9	26.7	-1.0	-25.9	0.2	298.5	2116.0	
Asian DM Quality [1]	144.2	20.6	7.0	9.6	202606	21.6	17.2	15.7	8.6	5.9	11.6	0.5	87.5	51.8
Astral [1]	870.3	-20.6	70.0	9.6	202603	24.2	21.2	12.6	5.6	-0.4	19.4	0.1	176.8	126.8
Astral Energy [1]	1480.8	-9.8	15.1	202606	88.8	-128.5	67.2	52.4	17.4	0.0	0.4	1507.3	382.6	
Atul [1]	1676.8	270.2	25.1	3.2	202606	25.0	92.0	15.8	59.1	0.5	14.9	0.0	719.8	5563.0
AU Small Finance [1]	1082.7	38.4	20.9	1.1	202606	18.2	34.9	-0.2	34.1	-0.2	19.0	0.0	120.0	13.4
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1661.0	65.1	25.5	2.6	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	5.2	12.4	0.2	1661.0	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	596.3	24.7	24.1	3.4	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	10.6	29.7	0.1	683.5	400.0
Avenue Super [1]	3890.3	46.9	83.0	10.4	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	-0.8	17.2	0.1	4916.3	3528.7
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	197.5	2.0	92.2	1.5	202606	17.5	-48.2	26.7	2.3	4.2	17.1	0.2	182.3	171.2
Axis Bank [2]	123.80	89.3	13.9	1.7	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	0.7	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3

BHEL [2]



Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

One of the harder parts of long-term investing is not deciding when to take risk, but when to reduce it. Suppose you are investing for a child's higher education 15 years away, a high equity allocation may be reasonable initially. But if the stock market falls 30 per cent when the goal is only a year away, there may simply not be enough time for the portfolio to recover.

This is the problem that lifecycle-based investment strategies available with several unit-linked insurance plans (ULIPs) attempt to address. If the policyholder opts for such a strategy, the insurer automatically switches between equity and debt funds according to a predetermined formula.

The underlying idea is quite simple. Take more investment risk when the goal is distant and progressively reduce it as the goal approaches. Many life insurers have their version of automated lifecycle strategies. In this piece, we will discuss a few. Note that such strategies are not exclusive to ULIPs. NPS has been offering it since many years, while some mutual funds are providing it from this year.

HOW THE WHEEL TURNS

Lifecycle strategies broadly follow the same principle, but insurers differ in how quickly they reduce equity exposure and

what triggers the shift. Some use years left to maturity, while others use the policyholder's age.

Consider Bajaj Life's Wheel of Life Portfolio Strategy. In its Future Wealth Gain IV ULIP, when 20 or more years remain to maturity, the allocation is entirely to equity funds — 20 per cent to a blue-chip equity fund, 50 per cent to an equity growth fund and 30 per cent to a mid-cap fund.

The allocation becomes progressively conservative thereafter. With 10 years remaining, equity falls to 70 per cent and bonds account for 30 per cent. At five years, equity is down to 40 per cent, while 55 per cent goes to bonds and 5 per cent to a liquid fund. In the final year, equity drops to zero, with 80 per cent in bonds and 20 per cent in liquid assets.

Axis Max Life follows the same years-to-maturity approach, but with a different pace of de-risking through its Dynamic Fund Allocation strategy. In the Platinum Wealth Plan, the predefined allocation is 80 per cent to its growth fund and 20 per cent to a secure fund when 16-20 years remain. Equity-oriented exposure falls to 70 per cent with 8-15 years remaining, 50 per cent with four-seven years remaining and 20 per cent during the last three years.

So, the principle is similar, but the glide paths clearly are not identical.

There is another way of doing

KEY POINTS

- Equity exposure falls as goals approach
- Debt exposure rises as maturity nears
- Automatic rebalancing reduces emotional investment decisions

it. Making age rather than policy maturity the trigger.

ICICI Prudential Life's LifeCycle based Portfolio Strategy 2, available with LifeTime Classic, divides investments between its Multi Cap Growth Fund and Income Fund according to the policyholder's age.

The allocation to the Multi Cap Growth Fund is 80 per cent up to age 25, 75 per cent at ages 26-35, and 65 per cent at 36-45. It declines further to 55 per cent at 46-55, 45 per cent at ages 56-65, and finally 35 per cent for ages 66 and above. The allocation is automatically rearranged when the Life Assured enters another age band.

There is also a maturity-linked safeguard. During the last 10 quarters of the policy, savings in the Multi Cap Growth Fund are systematically transferred to the Income Fund in 10 installments.

HDFC Life, too, offers an Automatic Asset Rebalancing Strategy in its Smart Pension Plan, where allocations between equity-oriented funds and a

debt-oriented fund change according to the number of years remaining to vesting.

CASE FOR AUTOMATION

For policyholders who do not actively manage investments, such strategies can address a genuine behavioural problem.

Investors frequently rebalance in the wrong direction. After a strong equity rally, they become comfortable with a larger equity allocation; after a crash, they become reluctant to hold equities. A predetermined glide path does the opposite of emotional market timing. The rule is decided beforehand and implemented irrespective of market sentiment.

More importantly, it reduces the risk of a sharp equity-market decline close to a financial goal. A 25 per cent market decline with 15 years remaining is very different from the same decline six months before money is required for college fees or retirement.

There is also convenience. A policyholder need not remember to shift money from equity to debt every few years or decide how much to move.

ONE SIZE DOESN'T FIT ALL

Automation should not be confused with optimisation.

An age-based strategy, for instance, assumes that people of similar ages require broadly similar asset allocations. That may be convenient, but a 50-year-old investing for a goal

three years away is different from another 50-year-old building wealth for the next 15 years.

A maturity-based strategy aligns better with a particular goal, but it brings another risk: de-risking too quickly.

If equities perform strongly during the later years, a portfolio that has mechanically moved heavily into debt will participate less in that upside.

Debt funds are also lower-risk, not risk-free. Interest-rate and credit risks remain, depending on the underlying portfolio.

Policyholders should therefore examine the actual allocation table rather than stopping at names such as "lifecycle", "dynamic" or "wheel of life". Ask four questions: How much equity will I hold today? When does de-risking begin? How much equity remains in final years? Can I exit or change strategy if my situation does?

Finally, asset allocation cannot make a poor insurance product a good one. Before buying a ULIP, investors still need to separately assess life cover, charges, fund choices, liquidity restrictions, taxation and whether the product itself fits their needs.

For an existing ULIP customer, however, an automated lifecycle option can be worth examining. Its biggest benefit is not that it knows where markets are headed. But, it makes sure your portfolio remembers that the date on which you need the money keeps getting closer.

Understanding merchant discount rate

BL. EXPLAINER. Is UPI becoming chargeable? Here's what you need to know

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

The Parliament on August 6 passed the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, *inter alia*, intending to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007. This move has stoked widespread speculation that the government's aim is to introduce MDR (Merchant Discount Rate) charges for UPI, which has remained free until now. Here's an explainer decluttering the noise around the move.

What is MDR?

The MDR is a fee charged by banks and payment processing companies (such as Visa and Mastercard) to merchants for each credit or debit card transaction made by customers. This fee ranges from 0.25 per cent to 1 per cent of the transaction value for debit card transactions, and from 1 per cent to 3 per cent for credit card transactions. MDR compensates banks and payment service providers (PSPs) for processing digital payments and maintaining supporting infrastructure.

What is likely the impact on MDR with the passing of the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026?

Through the Bill, the government aims to amend section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007. This section restricts banks and PSPs from imposing any

charge on a person making or receiving a payment using certain electronic modes of payment. These modes of payment are currently provided under section 269SU of the Income-tax Act, 1961, read with rule 119AA of the Income-tax Rules, 1962, namely, RuPay debit card, UPI and QR code-based UPI.

Now that the new Income-tax Act, 2025, is in force, the government plans to remove references to the old legislation and instead notify those modes of payment in a future Ministry of Finance notification. Going forward, one must refer to this notification to understand which modes of payment are exempt from MDR rather than to refer to the Income-tax Act.

Who is currently bearing the cost of operating UPI now?

Currently, banks and PSPs are largely bearing the cost. However, the government is incentivising them to an extent for person-to-merchant (P2M) transactions of less than ₹2,000 involving a 'small merchant'.

The FY27 Budget provides an allocation of ₹2,000 crore for the scheme. Although this is lower than the FY26 revised estimate of ₹2,196 crore, it remains well above the original FY26 Budget Estimate of ₹437 crore and the FY25 allocation of ₹1,923 crore.

Besides, NPCI, which owns and manages UPI, spent ₹2,270 crore in rev-



ALLEN EGENUSE / J

enue expenditure and ₹742 crore in capital expenditure in FY25 (latest available financials).

Will UPI become chargeable now?

There is little clarity on this at this point, leading to speculation. The government's move can be interpreted in two ways.

One, given that the Income-tax Act, 2025, has come into force, the move can be interpreted as merely removing the reference to the old Income-tax Act, 1961, in the Payment and Settlement Systems Act.

Two, the government could've amended the Payment and Settlement Sys-

tems Act to include a reference to the relevant provisions of the new Income-tax Act, 2025. Section 269SU and rule 119AA of the old tax legislation have largely been carried forward to section 187 of the Income-tax Act, 2025, and rule 133 of Income-tax Rules, 2026.

Instead, the government intends to notify the list of exempt payment modes itself, without referring to the taxation law.

Given that payment ecosystem players and the Lok Sabha Standing Committee on Finance have voiced the unsustainable nature of the status quo and called for MDR on UPI, the government's move in this manner

may be interpreted as addressing their grievance.

Nevertheless, expert opinion tilts towards the former view. According to Smrita Jha, Partner at Khaitan & Co, the amendment is simply a consequential legislative measure to preserve the operative force of this provision following the repeal and replacement of the Income-tax Act, 1961.

The amendment neither affects the substantive zero-MDR regime applicable to UPI transactions nor creates any new legal basis for levying charges that did not previously exist.

Any introduction of MDR on UPI would require an independent policy action by the Central Government through a separate notification.

Will a charge for using UPI be a dampener for users?

Consumers can reasonably expect not to be charged. Even in the current scenario with cards, it's the merchant who bears the charge. The government might even keep small merchants out of the UPI MDR purview. UPI MDR may be set at competitive rates relative to card MDR to encourage adoption.

However, merchants may resort to inflating the prices of goods and services to the extent of the possible UPI MDR, thereby ultimately passing the cost on to the consumer.

How this transpires in the long term remains to be seen.

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**THE ANDHRA SUGARS LIMITED**
REGISTERED OFFICE: VENKATARAYAPURAM, TANUKU-534215 (A.P)
PHONE:08819-224911 Email: info.tnk@theandhrasugars.com
website:www.theandhrasugars.com CIN: L15420AP1947PLC000326

Extract of Standalone/Consolidated Un-audited Financial Results for the Quarter Ended 30.06.2026
(As per Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47(1) of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015)

The Un-Audited Standalone & Consolidated Financial Results of the Company for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and were approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their meetings held on 8th August, 2026.

The Financial Results along with the Limited Review Reports have been posted on the Company's website at www.theandhrasugars.com and can also be accessed by Scanning the QR Code.



For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

P.NARENDRANATH CHOWDARY
Chairman & Managing Director
DIN:00015764

Place : Tanuku
Date : 08-08-2026

ALERTS.

Sunehra Pension Plan unveiled

Generali Central Life Insurance Co has launched the Sunehra Pension Plan, a participating (PAR), non-linked, pension, savings-oriented life insurance plan aimed at helping policyholders build a retirement corpus for their financial security. Beyond its insurance benefits, the plan also offers complimentary wellness services. Bonuses under the Sunehra Pension Plan begin accruing from the first policy year. The plan offers flexibility to choose a policy term ranging from five to 40 years. It also provides liquidity through partial withdrawals during financial emergencies, multiple premium payment options and the ability to enhance protection through optional riders.



**IDFC FIRST Bank Limited**
CIN: L65110TN2014PLC097792
Registered Office: KRM Towers, 7th Floor, No. 1, Harrington Road, Chetpet, Chennai - 600 031, Tamil Nadu, India; **Tel:** + 91 44 4564 4000.
Corporate Office: IDFC FIRST Bank Tower (The Square), C-61, G Block, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051, Maharashtra, India. **Tel:** + 91 22 7132 5500
Website: www.idfcfirst.bank.in; **E-mail:** bank.info@idfcfirstbank.com

NOTICE OF THE 12TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND INFORMATION ON E-VOTING

NOTICE is hereby given that the Twelfth (12th) Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the Members of IDFC FIRST Bank Limited ("the **Bank**") will be held on **Monday, August 31, 2026 at 02:00 p.m.** Indian Standard Time ("**IST**") , through Video Conferencing ("**VC**") / Other Audio-Visual Means ("**OAVM**") , in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 read with the Rules made thereunder ("the **Act**"), Securities and Exchange Board of India ("**SEBI**") (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, as amended ("**SEBI Listing Regulations**") and applicable circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs to transact the businesses set out in the Notice convening the AGM. The Members attending the AGM through VC/OAVM facility shall be reckoned for the purpose of quorum under Section 103 of the Act.

In compliance with the regulatory requirements, the Notice of the AGM and the Integrated Annual Report of the Bank for FY 2025-26 has been sent through electronic mode to all the Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Bank's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ("**RTA**") / Depository Participants ("**DP**"). The Notice of the AGM and Integrated Annual Report for FY 2025-26 is also made available on the Bank's website at www.idfcfirst.bank.in, on the website of the Stock Exchanges i.e., BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com respectively, and on the website of the Agency for e-voting i.e. National Securities Depository Limited ("**NSDL**") at <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com>.

A letter providing web-link for accessing the Integrated Annual Report for FY 2025-26 and the Notice is being sent by post to those shareholders who have not registered their e-mail address with their respective RTA / DP.

Pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 of the Act read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended, Regulation 44 of the SEBI Listing Regulations, Secretarial Standards on General Meetings ("**SS-2**") issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India and other Relevant Circulars, the Bank is pleased to provide the facility to exercise their right to vote through electronic means to its Members whose name is recorded in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories, as on **Monday, August 24, 2026 ("cut-off date")**, on all businesses as set out in the AGM Notice.

The Bank has engaged the services and made necessary arrangements with NSDL for facilitating voting through electronic means, as authorized e-voting agency. The Members may cast their votes remotely ("**remote e-voting**") on the dates mentioned herein below using the electronic voting platform of NSDL. The facility to vote through electronic voting system shall also be made available for Members at the AGM ("**e-voting**"). During this period, Members can select **EVEN – 140738** to cast their votes electronically. The Members attending the AGM who have not cast their vote(s) by remote e-voting will be able to vote at the AGM through e-voting mechanism. Further, a member may participate in the AGM even after exercising right to vote through remote e-voting but shall not be allowed to vote again in the meeting.

The **remote e-voting** period will commence on **Wednesday, August 26, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. (IST)** and will end on **Sunday, August 30, 2026, at 05:00 p.m. (IST)**. The e-voting module shall be disabled by NSDL for voting thereafter.

The voting rights of Members shall be in proportion to the equity shares held by them in the paid-up equity share capital of the Bank as on the cut-off date, subject to the provisions of the Banking Regulations Act, 1949, as amended.

Any person/ non-individual shareholder who acquires share(s) of the Bank and becomes a Member after dispatch of the Notice and holding shares as of the cut-off date, are requested to refer to the Notice of the AGM for the process to be adopted for obtaining the User ID and Password for casting the vote electronically.

Those Members who have not yet registered/updated his/her KYC details such as name, postal address, e-mail address, telephone/mobile numbers, Permanent Account Number, bank details etc. with the Bank/ RTA/ DP, are requested to do so immediately as explained herein below:

1. Physical Holding	Submit duly filled Form ISR-1 and such other documents as prescribed in the form either through physical mode with self-attestation and date at Kfin Technologies Limited, Selenium Tower B, Plot Nos. 31 & 32, Financial District, Gachibowli, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally Mandal, Hyderabad 500 032, Telangana, India or through e-mail at einward.ris@kfinitech.com with e-sign. Form ISR-1 is available on the website of the Bank at https://www.idfcfirstbank.com/investors .
2. Demat Holding	Please contact your DP and register/ update your e-mail address, bank account details, etc. in your demat account, as per the process advised by your DP.

In case of any queries, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions ("**FAQs**") for Shareholders and e-voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download section of <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com> or call on 022-4886 7000 or send a request at evoting@nsdl.com.

In case of any grievances connected with the facility for voting by electronic means, please contact Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Deputy Vice President, NSDL, T301, 3rd Floor, Naman Chambers, G Block, Plot No-C-32, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai- 400051 or write on evoting@nsdl.com.

**By order of the Board of Directors
For IDFC FIRST Bank Limited**
Sd/-
Satish Gaikwad
General Counsel & Company Secretary
FCS 6494

**Date: August 08, 2026
Place: Mumbai**



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	110.3	79421	1.1	0.7	1.2	12.6	12.7	13.2	0.42
*****	Invesco India Largecap	73.2	1847	1.8	0.7	7.7	14.1	11.9	12.4	0.34
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	91.3	53227	1.2	0.6	2.0	12.6	14.7	13.8	0.47
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	225.0	2571	1.7	0.7	4.0	12.1	11.3	12.1	0.33
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	62.9	17136	1.4	0.5	1.0	10.9	9.8	12.9	0.28
*****	JM Large Cap	156.6	402	2.1	0.8	4.7	11.4	11.3	10.8	0.31
*****	SBI Large Cap	95.1	55064	1.2	0.7	4.1	10.2	10.6	11.5	0.32
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	531.3	29029	1.4	0.8	2.4	11.1	10.7	11.4	0.31
***	Bandhan Large Cap	80.0	2061	1.7	0.8	5.3	13.3	11.5	12.2	0.33
***	DSP Large Cap	465.7	7190	1.5	0.8	0.4	11.6	10.0	10.6	0.30
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	84.8	1434	1.8	0.6	3.3	10.3	10.4	12.0	0.30
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1040.8	7256	1.5	0.9	3.1	10.8	9.0	10.3	0.24
***	HDFC Large Cap	1150.3	39024	1.3	0.8	2.6	10.6	12.3	12.3	0.38
***	HSBC Large Cap	487.7	1814	1.8	1.0	4.6	11.2	10.3	11.7	0.27
***	Kotak Large Cap	578.1	10772	1.5	0.6	2.8	11.3	10.3	11.9	0.29
***	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.7	700	2.0	0.7	-0.2	9.3	9.0	-	0.24
***	Tata Large Cap	519.3	2784	1.7	0.8	6.1	11.2	10.7	11.4	0.32
***	Groww Largecap	43.7	132	2.1	0.9	3.2	11.3	9.9	10.5	0.26
**	Mirae Asset Large Cap	114.4	38379	1.3	0.5	2.9	9.5	9.1	12.2	0.25
**	Union Largecap	23.5	437	2.1	1.3	1.4	8.8	8.8	-	0.23
**	UTI Large Cap	269.4	12303	1.5	0.8	0.1	8.4	8.1	10.9	0.21
*	Axis Large Cap	61.3	30913	1.3	0.7	2.8	9.9	7.2	11.7	0.16
*	LIC MF Large Cap	54.6	1387	1.9	0.9	-0.8	8.4	7.6	9.9	0.18
*	PGIM India Large Cap	338.4	547	2.1	0.8	0.8	7.5	7.2	9.6	0.17
-	Taurus Large Cap	169.0	56	2.1	1.9	9.3	14.4	11.3	10.1	0.30
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	141.4	18783	1.4	0.4	7.2	18.6	16.5	15.0	0.50
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1066.8	30971	1.3	0.7	9.6	17.0	17.2	15.2	0.58
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	128.2	3450	1.7	0.6	14.5	16.5	16.1	15.7	0.43
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	35.3	16469	1.4	0.6	9.1	15.9	12.7	-	0.33
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	354.4	29285	1.4	0.8	6.3	14.7	15.6	14.6	0.46
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	111.2	11164	1.5	0.6	10.9	23.5	17.3	16.1	0.46
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	187.9	6407	1.6	0.8	7.0	16.5	14.7	13.7	0.46
*****	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	93.8	491	2.1	0.9	10.1	14.3	12.0	12.4	0.34
*****	DSP Large & Mid Cap	629.9	17906	1.4	0.5	4.6	15.0	12.5	13.9	0.37
*****	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	91.6	4683	1.6	0.5	7.8	14.9	13.0	14.3	0.37
*****	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	29.9	5344	1.6	0.7	13.8	18.5	14.8	-	0.35
*****	Kotak Large & Midcap	359.0	31263	1.3	0.5	7.3	14.9	14.1	14.7	0.41
*****	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	159.7	44048	1.3	0.5	8.6	13.5	11.5	16.1	0.33
*****	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1528.6	7459	1.5	0.9	6.4	16.6	14.6	12.9	0.43
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	664.6	40850	1.3	0.6	8.3	14.1	14.2	14.5	0.44
*****	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	260.6	26062	1.4	0.5	2.2	13.5	11.5	14.6	0.32
*****	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	195.4	3450	1.7	1.1	3.7	12.6	11.0	11.3	0.31
*****	LIC MF Large & Midcap	39.8	3133	1.7	0.6	4.5	14.9	12.2	13.8	0.35
*****	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	94.4	6991	1.5	0.7	12.5	15.4	13.2	14.5	0.36
*****	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	968.4	5784	1.6	0.9	9.6	12.7	9.1	11.0	0.20
*****	Navi Large & Midcap	37.2	310	2.1	0.5	7.3	10.0	10.9	12.2	0.30
*****	Tata Large & Mid Cap	512.4	7901	1.5	0.6	-1.1	8.5	10.4	12.1	0.29
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2086.5	106496	1.1	0.6	6.4	17.0	17.9	15.7	0.60
*****	JM Flexicap	101.2	5185	1.6	0.6	5.7	15.5	16.4	15.6	0.46
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	84.2	143388	1.0	0.5	0.3	13.8	12.7	16.6	0.45
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1986.1	26727	1.4	0.7	13.0	16.2	12.7	13.7	0.36
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	39.7	3484	1.6	0.5	6.5	14.9	12.9	14.2	0.36
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1632.7	19274	1.4	0.8	1.5	12.9	13.2	12.9	0.38
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	234.7	5633	1.6	0.9	9.0	16.5	13.7	12.6	0.35
*****	Axis Flexi Cap	28.5	13328	1.5	0.7	7.4	14.1	9.8	-	0.24
*****	Bandhan Flexi Cap	214.5	7417	1.5	0.9	4.4	13.1	10.9	10.7	0.30
*****	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	348.6	13615	1.5	0.5	3.1	12.1	10.5	13.7	0.30
*****	DSP Flexi Cap	105.5	12236	1.5	0.6	5.4	12.8	10.5	13.4	0.27
*****	Kotak Flexicap	86.6	55850	1.2	0.5	3.6	12.9	11.5	12.8	0.32
*****	Navi Flexi Cap	25.3	281	2.1	0.5	14.3	11.4	11.3	-	0.32
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	37.4	5898	1.6	0.5	3.9	10.2	8.2	13.2	0.21
*****	Union Flexi Cap	53.0	2376	1.7	0.8	5.6	11.7	10.9	12.7	0.30
*****	LIC MF Flexi Cap	108.2	1075	1.9	0.9	12.6	12.9	11.1	10.4	0.28
*****	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	63.6	13940	1.4	0.7	3.0	19.5	12.8	12.6	0.31
*****	SBI Flexicap	109.8	22685	1.4	0.7	3.0	9.0	8.9	11.4	0.24
*****	Tata Flexi Cap	24.1	3705	1.6	0.6	1.2	11.1	9.9	-	0.28
*****	Shriram Flexi Cap	20.3	134	2.1	0.8	2.2	8.5	8.0	-	0.18
*****	Taurus Flexi Cap	240.5	369	2.1	2.0	9.1	13.2	11.2	9.8	0.30
*****	UTI Flexi Cap	330.0	24036	1.4	0.8	2.9	8.9	6.0	11.5	0.12
-	Quant Flexi Cap	110.3	7140	1.5	0.6	17.5	16.8	14.9	18.7	0.39
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	300.7	3339	1.7	0.8	7.6	15.3	14.1	13.9	0.38
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	876.4	18194	1.4	0.8	12.1	17.4	15.6	14.5	0.48
-	Invesco India Multicap	132.6	4302	1.6	0.6	3.1	13.9	11.8	13.2	0.29
-	ITI Multi Cap	26.1	1470	1.8	0.5	12.8	17.1	12.6	-	0.32
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	39.2	6926	1.5	0.5	12.7	17.6	15.4	-	0.42
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	307.6	54585	1.2	0.6	4.0	15.2	18.7	15.3	0.57
-	Quant Multi Cap	668.2	7761	1.5	0.6	10.9	11.1	11.4	17.2	0.29
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	397.0	2915	1.7	0.8	5.5	14.2	13.0	14.4	0.36
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	109.7	17748	1.4	0.4	10.4	22.1	18.2	18.0	0.50
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4571.3	49169	1.2	0.6	12.1	20.8	19.1	18.0	0.55
*****	Quant Mid Cap	225.7	8138	1.5	0.7	7.5	13.6	15.6	17.1	0.41
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	213.6	100858	1.1	0.6	11.9	19.7	19.9	17.3	0.61
*****	Invesco India Midcap	200.1	13767	1.5	0.5	12.2	24.6	19.5	18.3	0.51
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	37.1	5076	1.6	0.5	14.9	20.8	17.6	-	0.48
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	102.4	40036	1.3	0.7	0.2	19.4	22.0	16.4	0.55
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	113.0	2513	1.7	0.5	14.3	18.1	15.0	15.1	0.43
*****	HSBC Midcap	467.7	15352	1.4	0.5	21.4	24.9	18.5	16.9	0.46
*****	ICICI Pru Midcap	344.0	7846	1.5	0.9	16.8	23.1	17.5	16.4	0.50
*****	Kotak Midcap	147.6	67611	1.2	0.3	9.6	19.1	16.8	17.1	0.48
*****	PGIM India Midcap	66.6	11071	1.5	0.5	2.9	11.7	11.1	15.2	0.31
*****	SBI Midcap	244.5	24127	1.4	0.7	8.4	12.6	14.2	13.6	0.42
*****	Sundaram Mid Cap	1528.4	14026	1.5	0.8	11.7	21.0	18.1	14.5	0.51
*****	Tata Mid Cap	466.2	6056	1.6	0.5	10.3	16.2	15.1	15.8	0.45
*****	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	856.9	6624	1.6	0.9	10.5	17.2	14.7	13.3	0.40
*****	Axis Midcap	122.3	33803	1.3	0.5	9.0	17.3	13.7	16.6	0.38
*****	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2879.3	12490	1.5	0.8	6.5	17.6	14.7	14.1	0.39
*****	UTI Mid Cap	316.5	12379	1.5	0.7	6.8	13.0	12.4	13.6	0.33
*****	DSP Midcap	157.5	20170	1.4	0.6	9.1	16.0	12.1	13.9	0.32
*****	LIC MF Midcap	31.0	376	2.1	1.2	8.1	17.4	13.1	-	0.33
*****	Taurus Mid Cap	129.8	135	2.1	1.7	8.7	12.1	12.7	14.5	0.30
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	56.9	2572	1.7	0.4	24.2	21.7	18.9	-	0.43
*****	Quant Small Cap	287.9	32739	1.3	0.6	15.3	18.2	17.9	19.9	0.42
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	48.1	6580	1.6	0.4	11.5	16.6	16.8	-	0.44

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	48.2	13385	1.5	0.4	17.3	23.2	19.3	-	0.47
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	184.4	78407	1.1	0.5	10.8	16.8	19.0	20.6	0.48
*****	Union Small Cap	59.0	2268	1.7	0.8	22.8	18.4	16.7	16.3	0.39
*****	AXIS Small Cap	116.1	29394	1.4	0.6	11.0	16.0	15.9	18.2	0.45
*****	Canara Robeco Small Cap	41.2	14231	1.5	0.4	7.9	13.5	15.1	-	0.39
*****	DSP Small Cap	226.1	19635	1.4	0.7	17.3	17.5	17.0	16.4	0.43
*****	HSBC Small Cap	89.0	17830	1.4	0.6	11.7	15.5	17.1	17.8	0.40
*****	Kotak Small Cap	275.3	18691	1.4	0.5	7.7	12.7	12.8	16.3	0.32
*****	LIC MF Small Cap	34.3	758	2.0	0.8	15.8	18.0	17.6	-	0.41
*****	Sundaram Small Cap	297.1	3872	1.6	0.7	18.3	18.1	16.7	14.5	0.41
*****	Franklin Ind Small Cap	180.6	14336	1.5						

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2144.9	573	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.2	6.4	6.1	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	450.2	68800	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.7	6.7	6.4	-
- Axis Liquid	3112.1	56438	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.8	6.4	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3371.3	19031	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.5	6.6	6.3	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3218.3	1728	0.1	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.4	1.50
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3209.4	12206	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.6	6.3	1.20
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3361.7	6792	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- DSP Liquidity	3989.1	22962	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.8	6.4	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3573.7	13796	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.8	6.4	-
- Groww Liquid	2700.9	323	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- HDFC Liquid	5479.3	65870	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- HSBC Liquid	2784.3	20047	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	413.3	61558	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3839.6	20723	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.7	6.7	6.4	-
- ITI Liquid	1451.1	48	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.2	6.3	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	76.1	2849	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.6	6.2	-
- Kotak Liquid	5643.5	51309	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5048.4	16809	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1817.3	1280	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2926.6	13190	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.5	6.6	6.3	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.7	966	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.1	6.1	5.9	-
- Navi Liquid	30.2	76	0.2	0.2	5.5	5.8	5.8	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6816.1	41346	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1548.2	7009	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- PGIM India Liquid	363.7	787	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.7	6.8	6.4	1.90
- Quant Liquid	43.9	1603	0.5	0.3	5.7	5.8	5.8	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.2	537	0.2	0.1	5.9	5.9	5.9	5.8	-
- SBI Liquid	4364.4	84055	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2462.5	10633	0.3	0.1	7.2	6.9	6.8	6.3	-
- Tata Liquid	4398.4	27603	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1355.6	1130	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.5	6.5	6.2	-
- Union Liquid	2687.7	7564	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.7	6.4	-
- UTI Liquid	458.3	26728	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.7	6.4	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1500.4	672	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.5	6.6	6.2	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1470.2	9747	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1446.3	10178	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1450.8	1123	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1390.9	63	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.8	5.5	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1433.7	557	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1414.1	444	0.1	0.1	5.3	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1460.2	3601	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1413.2	120	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1425.8	926	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1403.1	27	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4022.0	11145	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1422.8	4766	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1468.5	13144	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1380.6	591	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1377.5	16	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
- JM Overnight	1382.7	99	0.1	0.1	4.8	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- Kotak Overnight	1453.2	8818	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1409.7	662	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1409.3	281	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1397.8	1562	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	146.3	8376	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1407.1	167	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4398.3	29876	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1446.1	1896	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1435.8	5278	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1433.2	613	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3711.6	5089	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.3	26646	0.9	0.3	5.0	6.3	5.7	6.0	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.9	10362	0.9	0.3	5.2	6.2	5.8	6.0	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.5	8190	0.9	0.3	4.7	5.9	5.5	5.7	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.6	48	0.9	0.4	5.6	5.6	5.4	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.1	1147	1.0	0.3	4.3	5.6	5.3	5.6	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.9	6529	0.9	0.3	5.3	6.1	5.7	5.9	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.7	15062	0.9	0.3	5.1	6.4	5.9	6.0	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.7	23772	0.8	0.3	4.7	6.2	5.8	6.1	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.2	2944	0.8	0.2	5.3	6.3	6.0	6.1	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.6	33423	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.4	6.0	6.1	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	34.0	28526	0.9	0.3	4.9	6.2	5.7	6.1	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.8	72	0.8	0.2	5.2	5.3	5.5	5.8	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.6	391	0.9	0.4	4.8	5.8	5.4	5.7	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	40.0	72409	0.8	0.3	5.2	6.4	5.9	6.1	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.7	265	0.7	0.2	4.5	6.1	5.8	5.9	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.1	126	1.0	0.3	3.9	5.3	5.0	5.4	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.9	3737	0.8	0.1	4.9	6.2	5.5	5.9	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.3	16638	0.9	0.3	4.8	6.2	5.7	6.0	0.60
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.5	83	0.9	0.3	5.4	6.0	5.7	5.7	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	36.1	45923	0.8	0.3	4.8	6.1	5.7	6.0	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.4	650	0.8	0.2	4.1	6.0	5.8	6.0	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.3	24725	0.9	0.3	4.9	6.1	5.8	6.0	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.9	246	0.9	0.3	5.6	6.4	5.8	5.9	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.4	11152	0.7	0.2	5.2	6.2	5.8	6.1	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

*****	Aditya Birla SL Savings	587.9	18189	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.2	7.3	6.5	9.68
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1652.3	649	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.1	6.4	-
*****	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1402.9	1916	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.4	12.70
*****	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.3	4205	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
*****	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1450.5	3322	0.3	0.1	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.3	-
*****	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.7	15455	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.3	7.92
*****	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4307.4	11659	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.1	22.83
****	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.7	5908	1.1	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.6	5.8	8.50
****	DSP Ultra Short	3631.4	4456	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.8	6.81
****	HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.2	16678	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.9	6.2	8.57
****	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2882.1	1073	0.7	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.0	4.47
****	Kotak Savings	45.8	15708	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.8	6.0	6.00
****	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1470.8	205	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.1	1.22
****	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6390.5	11165	0.5	0.3	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.2	11.83
****	Tata Ultra Short Term	15.1	6378	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.6	5.8	8.62
****	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4521.1	3444	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	6.5	11.75
****	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1449.5	552	0.7	0.3	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.8	-
****	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3370.5	168	0.9	0.4	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.7	6.56
****	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4047.8	580	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.4	6.5	5.6	-
****	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1406.7	509	1.2	0.2	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.7	1.00
****	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	36.2	176	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.7	2.84
****	ITI Ultra Short Term	1314.5	163	0.8	0.2	5.7	6.2	6.3	5.5	-
****	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.4	515	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.5	5.7	5.0	-
****	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2843.7	2284	1.3	0.2	5.2	5.9	6.0	5.3	1.36

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

*****	ICICI Pru Savings	583.8	21735	0.5	0.4	6.4	7.3	7.4	6.6	6.69
*****	UTI Low Duration	3800.7	2386	0.4	0.3	6.2	7.2	7.2	7.4	8.01
*****	Axis Treasury Advantage	3311.6	4637	0.6	0.3	6.1	7.1	7.1	6.3	7.07
*****	Bandhan Low Duration	41.2	6583	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
*****	HDFC Low Duration	61.6	18420	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.8	6.9	6.1	11.33
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.7	994	0.8	0.3	6.0	7.6	7.5	6.4	6.70
****	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	698.3	9914	1.0	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.6	5.9	11.21

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

★★★★	Canara Robeco Savings	45.1	1086	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
★★★★	DSP Low Duration	21.2	4478	0.5	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
★★★★	Invesco India Low Duration	4039.5	1640	0.5	0.3	5.8	6.8	7.0	6.1	9.52
★★★★	JM Low Duration	39.5	217	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.8	6.0	3.44
★★★★	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2409.7	2044	0.7	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.8	5.9	7.34
★★★★	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3997.4	7804	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.9	6.9	6.1	7.56
★★★★	Tata Treasury Advantage	4203.5	2240	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.9	7.0	6.1	6.52
★★★★	Kotak Low Duration	3562.6	12083	1.0	0.4	5.6	6.7	6.8	5.9	8.78
★★★★	LIC MF Low Duration	42.2	174.4	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.7	5.8	5.95
★★★★	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1742.4	541	0.9	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.8	13.64
★★★	SBI Low Duration	3717.8	13102	0.8	0.4	5.5	6.6	6.7	5.9	4.10
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.7	391	0.9	0.2	5.6	6.5	6.6	5.8	-
★★★	Sundaram Low Duration	3674.4	433	1.0	0.3	5.3	6.5	6.6	5.8	2.24

